BOUDICA

Written by

Jesse Johnson

Copyright Symphony of Violence Films Inc.,
(818) 209 4724

BOUDICA.

Text on Screen: **Summer AD 43**

"Under the orders of Emperor Claudius an army commanded by senator Aulus Plautius, landed at Richborough, Kent.

The Romans met a large army of Britons, under the Catuvellauni King Caratacus. The Britons were defeated in a two-day battle.

Within 18 years Britain was under total Roman authority."

1 EXT. ROMAN FORUM - DAY 1

A CENTURION followed by a phalanx of TEN SOLDIERS, all wear helmets peaked with black helmet crest plumes.

The phalanx of legionnaires marches past a lone PRAETORIAN CENTURION, who enters the building.

2 INT. GREAT BASILICA - DAY 2

The Praetorian Centurion quietly enters the dark room, exchanging places with another CENTURION. To keep silent vigil.

The room is lit by shafts of light, BODIES sleeping, Farlernian wine Amphoras and wine cups.

GAIUS SUETONIUS PAULINUS, a *Praefectus Castrorum*, helmet under his arm listens to EMPEROR NERO (20'S,) naked back to us he embraces a (harp-like) LYRE.

NERO
There were women amongst their ranks?

PAULINUS
In robes of black with their hair disheveled and wild, they brandished torches ahead of the Druids.

NERO
And what did these cult leaders of Mona do when they beheld your invasion force?

PAULINUS
They danced, as if in a trance. Chanting.
(MORE)

PAULINUS (CONT'D)
The numbers of warriors should have offered us significant challenge.

NERO
But that they kneeled?

PAULINUS
Yes. We encountered superficial resistance from the Ordovices.

NERO
So, even when faced with the massed fighting force of the first Centurion Legion of the first cohort. These experienced Celt fighting men kneeled. Trusting their religious leaders would offer them salvation against your sword?

PAULINUS
Yes, it appears that way, Dominus.

NERO
As Praefectus Castrorum in charge, what did you have you men do?

PAULINUS
I advanced in triple line flexible phalanx. The Phoulkon tactic.

Intercut with:

3 EXT. MONA (ANGLESEY) - DAY 3

A mass of BARBARIAN WARRIORS on the beach, men and women. Protecting a circle of Druids, who lift their hands to heaven, showering imprecations towards the invaders.

Paulinus watches the Druid ceremony from the beachhead as his flat-bottomed boats unload HUNDREDS OF ROMAN SOLDIERS.

4 INT. GREAT BASILICA - DAY 4

NERO
How did your men fair when faced by women in combat?

PAULINUS
Some flinched as they might before any fanatic enemy. When reassured by their General, they cut them down as they would any other enemy.

NERO
You slaughtered them?

PAULINUS
As is my duty to Rome.

NERO
Women as well?

Paulinus nods.

5 EXT. MONA (ANGLESEY) - DAY 5

A small group of fanatical Welsh ORDOVICES attack, and are summarily defeated. A FEMALE WARRIOR SHRIEKS attacking the Romans, she draws blood but is swiftly dispatched.

Paulinus legion then slices through the Celtic Druid army.

Causing absolute destruction, limbs and skulls, scalps and fingers are severed and crushed. The Celtic army doesn't fight back. Kneeling they're struck down on the spot.

6 INT. GREAT BASILICA - DAY 6

NERO
You assure me that this Cucullus is finished?

PAULINUS
We enveloped the barbarians in their own flames. My men demolished the groves consecrated to their savage cult. We considered it our pious duty to slake the altars with captive blood and to consult their deities by means of their own entrails.

7 EXT. MONA (ANGLESEY) - NIGHT 7

Paulinus hard face is lit by flames.

A STACK OF HUMAN BODIES twelve feet high burns, the burning pyre is set in a circle of STONE-HENGE like rocks.

ROMAN SOLDIERS throw buckets of bitumen-tar to feed the flames.

DOZENS OF CELTS kneel, their throats SYSTEMATICALLY CUT by gore-stained Roman soldiers. Blood streaming over the flat-rock of the henge in a small river.

8 INT. GREAT BASILICA - DAY 8

NERO
Did you question the Cucullus leader before defiling him to his Gods?

Paulinus is clearly stuck for words.

NERO (CONT'D)
Why do you pause?

PAULINUS
He was a fanatic.

NERO
What method of torture did you use?

PAULINUS
Damnatio ad bestias.

NERO
Excellent choice, Carthaginian style.

9 EXT. MONA (ANGLESEY) - NIGHT 9

The DRUID ELDER has his stomach sliced open, intestines drop. Gargling in agony, blank faced soldiers do their work.

Handfuls of grain are pushed inside his stomach cavity.

Paulinus watches as several Roman Soldiers interrogate him, he yells at them.

The Druids stomach is sewn closed and he's lashed to a beam.

Paulinus nods.

THREE WILD BOAR are released on the Druid nosing towards the smell of grain in his stomach. His screams are deafening.

10 INT. GREAT BASILICA - DAY 10

PAULINUS
The Celt Cucullus believe in the "Furies." Women warriors who symbolize vengeance and rebirth.
(beat)
That a woman warrior will be their salvation. That she will end the Roman occupation of Britania.

NERO
Interesting.

PAULINUS
The words of a dying fanatic, Caesar.

Nero takes a breath, looks over the wreck of last nights party. Moving a woman's sleeping limb, he stands naked.

NERO
I have wonderful dreams of abandoning the throne of Rome. I'm highly regarded as a musician in certain circles, "I have only to appear and sing to have peace once more in Gaul." Did you know that? But, we cannot just do as we dream, can we, brave Paulinus?

PAULINUS
We cannot.

NERO
We need to make sure that they don't find their savior.
(pause)
As Augustus I've issued a strict decree forbidding women from holding a position of influence, martial, judicial or otherwise. *Apollo grant me strength*; we don't need another woman like my mother. This decree must be upheld verbatim and under threat of severe punishment. Especially amongst the tribes of the island, Britannia.

PAULINUS
Your Majesty.

NERO
Give your sister my best regards, Paulinus.

Nero drinks from a glass wine-mug. Paulinus leaves.

11 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MORNING 11

Text on Screen: **Summer AD 61**

A Celtic-Keldur style TURF-ROOFED HOUSE, a central area built around a fire-pit, sun shafts in the misty interior.

Two enormous HUNTING HOUNDS pick through left overs. Branches of herbs and onions, garlic hang from the ceiling.

TWO COWS look inside in over a barn-style door, awaiting their breakfast.

A sprawling sleeping-area, a MAN (Prasutagus) and WOMAN (Boudica) sleep, their TWO DAUGHTERS, AIFE(11 yrs) and BRE(13 yrs) sleep beneath skins. A HOUND, TWO CATS and a GOOSE sleep beside the bed, the extended family stirs in the morning light.

Outside a ROOSTER crows in the day.

Boudica rises naked from the communal bed, kisses her husband and two daughters, padding into the fire area.

Washing from a HUGE WATER URN, lifts her head and smiles at a Hound who approaches curiously. **Boudica will have an affect on animals throughout this story, calming them, attracting them.*

BOUDICA
Good morning.

She dries, wrapping herself in a wolf-pelt.

Boudica opens a huge leather and wood case. These are her jewels, gold and pearls, Roman trade goods, but the piece Boudica is never without is her GOLDEN QUEEN'S TORQUE, fastening it around her neck. **It is how she will come be identified in battle but now it is simply an object of beauty.*

She kneels and blows the embers from the night before and feeds the fire fresh kindling, a flame flickers beneath the kettle urn.

Boudica watches the sun rise over her hill-top fortified CRANNOG Village homestead.

Title on screen: **BOUDICA.**

12 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - CONTINUOUS 12

Livestock, CATTLE, SHEEP AND PIGS, and servants quarters. HORSES corals and tents. Stores of WHEAT, BARLEY AND OATS, which grow beyond the fortified defenses.

Surrounded by a wood and stone fortification and central STONE TOWER where...

...A Guard, CIARáN, warriors arms, nods at Boudica from the fortification, she nods back.

Two FEMALE SERVANTS/slaves wake, stretching, nodding and bowing to Boudica as they scurry into the Keldur.

13 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - CONTINUOUS 13

The Servants start to prepare breakfast of RABBIT BROTH and berries.

Prasutagus drifts up behind Boudica, embracing her, kissing her neck, then lustily, biting on her ear, he kisses her back and shoulders.

**Boudica is known as TRINA, Queen of the Iceni, for now.*

PRASUTAGUS
(whisper)
So help me, I love you more every day, is it possible that you never age my most wonderful Goddess of the forest. Is it the smell of that wild Trinovante blood that excites me? You’ve made me the luckiest man alive.

She’s starting to reciprocate.

BOUDICA
And you, my king, have made me the proudest mother, wife and queen.

Boudica turns to face him.

PRASUTAGUS
Let me have you now, like old times? Wrapped in the morning half light, minds groggy, not asleep or awake.

BOUDICA
Oh, you're definitely awake...

Prasutagus holds her face in his hands, kissing her. She breaks away, whispering.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
...Whatever we do this morning, my noble, brave and oh so worthy king of the Iceni we do for an audience. An audience of several servants, a half dozen guards and two curious little girls.

PRASUTAGUS
They're awake, aren't they?

Boudica smiles.

Prasutagus looks over his shoulder, and his TWO DAUGHTERS watch from the bed, bursting into noisy laughter.

Boudica laughs, then Prasutagus roars with laughter, we get the feeling this little family laughs at each other a lot.

Ciarán the head-guard, nudges past the cows, looking inside.

CIARÁN
Good day my king, may I join you for breakfast?

PRASUTAGUS
You and the entire fort, dear Ciarán, of course.

CIARÁN
I travelled through the night, and it was a cold one.

PRASUTAGUS
Come on in, warm yourself at my hearth.

14 INT. KELDUR EATING AREA - DAY 14

Boudica's family and Ciarán are served rabbit broth around a large central table. The girls secretly feed the dogs from the table. Boudica watches her King.

PRASUTAGUS
Apologies Ciarán, our offspring have the savage blood of the ancients running in their veins like their mother.

BOUDICA
Your offspring are wild like children who are indulged.

AIFE
I'm only giving them the chewy bits, I don't like the chewy bits.

BRE
Gristle, that's the gristle from the rabbit's joints.

AIFE
The hounds like it, so it's an "equitable deal."

PRASUTAGUS
An "equitable deal," where did you hear that?

BOUDICA
She's the daughter of a King, a very intelligent and quick witted daughter who will serve as a great queen one day.

BRE
We are a colony in the Roman Empire. We worship Emperor Augustus as God. The Emperor has forbidden women from seeking positions of power. Queen is a titular position, in as much as you are married to the King, therefore it's not a position of power.

PRASUTAGUS
The joys of a Roman education.
(to Ciarán)
How goes it in Camulos?

CIARÁN
We welcomed a new Governor, Catus Decianus.

PRASUTAGUS
Do I need to be concerned?

CIARÁN
He's Roman. Spoiled in Africa, hates it here. He'll transfer home at the first insurrection.

PRASUTAGUS
Hopefully.

Prasutagus growls at the HOUND then hugs it tight.

A Roman TUTOR arrives, he wears a Roman Tunic, Focale/scarf, breeches and short-sword.

BOUDICA
Latin study, girls.

The girls sigh, they do not like Latin study. They leave the table joining their Tutor.

PRASUTAGUS
(quietly)
We earn money to pay a Roman Tutor to teach our daughters the language of our occupier, so that they might understand how to navigate a future. A future where my rule is the distant memory of an old colony.

BOUDICA
We must change, if we don't want to be left alone in the cold like barbarian *Brigantes*.

PRASUTAGUS
I love my barbarian wife.

BOUDICA
You have king-like things to discuss with brave Ciarán, my love. I have a riding lesson and then I am taking the girls to market. We'll come find you.

Boudica kisses him on the forehead. He gently holds her.

Ciarán stands out of respect.

PRASUTAGUS
Promise me you'll always find me?

Boudica smiles.

BOUDICA
I promise.

15 EXT. KELDUR FENCED PADDOCK - DAY 15

Boudica canters her HORSE in a figure-eight.

Mud and dirt flying, she's VERY good.

A TRAINER in leather armor watches closely.

TRAINER
Feel her breath, flexing, understand she wants to be guided, told what to do. She will be confused if you are confused, fearful if you are fearful.

As if in slow-motion, Boudica flexes, leaning close to the horse, the horse breathes deep, nostrils flared, shoulder muscles shredding and tensing.

TRAINER (CONT'D)
She's of noble birth like you, she needs to be dominated. You must be brutal but committed of mind.

Boudica whips the horse around and back, trotting.

TRAINER (CONT'D)
Now let her breathe, let her know that you know she gave her best.

Boudica releases, folds her hands behind her.

Galloping in this manner.

TRAINER (CONT'D)
Breath when she breathes, look where she looks. Find her rhythm, Queen. Now without using your hands, slow her to a walk.

Boudica does so.

Boudica pats the horse. Trotting, it breaths-hard catching it's breath, flared nostrils - a very jumpy animal.

BOUDICA
I want to buy this horse, let no one else ride her, I will talk to my husband.

TRAINER
(laughing)
No one else will ride this horse, my Queen.

BOUDICA
Do you laugh at me?

TRAINER
Sincerest apologies, my Lady.

BOUDICA
Then what?

TRAINER
This horse is the most foul-tempered beast I've ever encountered. No one else can ride her. You're the only one that pays her any care.

BOUDICA
You're Iceni blood?

TRAINER
I am, Ma'am.

BOUDICA
What do you know of me?

TRAINER
You are Queen of the Iceni, but...

BOUDICA
But what?

TRAINER
You are queen because you married the King of the Iceni.

BOUDICA
Then what am I?

TRAINER
It is not for me to say, you are my Queen, and that is all that matters.

BOUDICA
I asked you a question?

TRAINER
You are Trinovantes, your spirit is wild as the spirit of the Goddess *Epona* and where the Iceni are short, you are tall.

BOUDICA
Is my place as Queen here harmed by my impure origins?

TRAINER
Your blood provides an ancient wild-fire to the royal-line of the Iceni. You're of the finest stock there is.

BOUDICA
You talk of me like a horse.

TRAINER
That is all I know, Queen.

Boudica doesn't know if he is being sincere or obsequious.

16 INT. BATHHOUSE - DAY 16

Boudica and her daughters sit, up to their necks in water, a small private bath-house. The water is heated by a furnace in the corner and steam fills the air, their hair is wrapped in cotton shawls.

Boudica smiles, the daughters smile-back.

17 INT. BATHHOUSE MASSAGE TABLE - DAY 17

The three girls lay belly down, their backs and arms are massaged with oil.

A COPPER TOOL is used to scrape the oil off, exfoliating the skin.

18 INT. COSMETAE CULTUS - DAY 18

The slaves sit watching STREET MUSICIANS PLAY outside, as...

Boudica sits in a comfortable carved-chair with two COSMETAE tending her. Her two daughters are tended by one Cosmetae each.

COSMETAE
First a vivid crimson dye from the crushed bodies of the rare Indian cochineal insect will be applied to your cut nails, this will dry as we work.

BOUDICA
Sounds wonderful.

AIFE
Unless you're the Cochineal.

COSMETAE
(whispering)
We import fashionable cosmetics from Germany, Gaul and China. Some are so expensive and rare, that the Emperor himself chokes when he pays for his wife's bill.

BOUDICA
That's excessive.

COSMETAE
Well, you're lucky, you don't need to enhance. You have naturally pale skin, most fashionable and very lucky. I have a dignitary who washes her face in asses milk seven times a day to try to keep it white.

The girls fingers are painted crimson with delicate brushes.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
Then a wondrous mask application of cream of the sweat of sheep's wool, fresh Lanolin cream.

The FATTY CREAM is massaged into the three girl's faces.

BOUDICA
My husband hates the smell of Lanolin.

COSMETAE
When we're finished the smell will be gone, my Queen.

A resin-paste is applied to Boudica's forehead.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
Excess hair, except on the head is not considered fashionable at all this season.

The resins ripped off removing hair around the eye-brows, Boudica, grimaces. Her daughters LAUGH LOUDLY.

The girl's hair is BRAIDED entwined with RIBBON-STRANDS, SEWN WITH WOOL up and behind their heads.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
This is a style inspired by Galeria Fundana, wife of Aulus Vitellius proconsul of Africa.
It is high fashion in Rome right now.

A tiny BRASS holder in the shape of an eyebrow is used to grind charcoal.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
We grind birch ash and add a drop of fat, with saffron and antimony to sweeten the aroma, to magnify the eye in the style of the Augusta, *Agippina* the Younger.

The three girl's lids are lined with EYE MAKE-UP painted with an IVORY TOOL.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
As Claudian praised the beauty of Honorius' consort Maria: "How fine a space between do your delicate eyebrows meet on your forehead."

Then a BLUE COLOR PASTE is hand applied as shadow.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
Ground Lapis Lazuli in a style that was inspired by the Egyptians. So beautiful it is said that the "Lex Oppia" tried to ban it's use. But fashion is fashion. You can't hold up the progress of beauty.

The make-up is delicately rimmed around the eyes.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
A pomace of crocodile excrement, honey, sheep placenta, vinegar, bile, sulfur, vinegar, onions with poultry fat, white lead, and barley with vetch.

The cosmetae rub this cream into the neck and cheeks of the girls.

COSMETAE (CONT'D)
The Romans hate wrinkles, sun-spots and blemishes, your skin is good, my Queen, but preventative measures must always be explored.

BOUDICA
Of course they must, as in any defense.

Boudica's two daughters have tiny SPLENIA cut-out (paper thin leather) stickers placed-carefully on their foreheads, one a "crescent moon," the other a "star." They inspect these to their satisfaction with hand mirrors.

Rouge is gently applied with a SOFT BRUSH to the girls cheeks.

COSMETAE
Rouge for the cheeks, Red ochre imported from Belgium and ground against mortar stone into the finest powder. Pale skin is of the utmost importance to the well groomed Roman Lady, but a little vermillion in the cheeks is important.

BOUDICA
So important.

The girls enjoy the attention and we get the idea this is a part of a routine they enjoy.

They play with a small toy-dog, a Pekingese style. *"Can we get a dog?" "What type of dog is this?"*

Boudica looks at the fabric on the Cosmetae's robe.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Such a beautiful color, wherever did you find it?

COSMETAE
From the Oppida, outside of Roman security lines. It was cheap there, it's where the Barbarians and thieves go. Where the Roman traders find wares to resell.

19 EXT. ROMAN TOWN - DAY 19

Boudica her daughters and two slaves walk down an avenue, TEN CRUCIFIXES. Either side of the pathway.

BOUDICA
What is the matter, you both look terrified.

SLAVE
We should not go to the Oppida.

BOUDICA
The Roman's are everywhere, look what they do to thieves.

SLAVE
These are not criminals, they're Christians.

BOUDICA
Oh.

BRE
Christians don't mix well with other religions. So the Romans crucify them, or feed them to animals.

AIFE
These are the lucky ones, usually they're crucified upside down.

SLAVE
We should go back.

BOUDICA
I'll buy a bolt of that material, then we can hurry back.

20 EXT. OPPIDA ROMAN TRADING VILLAGE - DAY 20

Trade buildings and artisan's huts. Traders shout and call bargains prices and sell their wares.

It's busy as many goods are bought, sold and traded here. Animals in the street, wine Urns and metal and wood workers flourish.

ROMAN SOLDIERS wander and stand guard, wrapped against the weather.

Boudica and her two daughters, and two slaves shop, wearing their new make-up and hair-styles.

Boudica and Bre look at try different perfumes from BLOW-GLASS BOTTLES.

Aife watches a STREET BAND. A lyre, pandura and tibia, a wind instrument made from human bone. The rhythm section rattles along thanks to a cup and beads.

The daughters as all intelligent and articulate teens do, innocently question the world around them.

AIFE
That is the temple to Spes, the goddess of hope. Built by the Emperor Claudius. Spes is one of the divine personifications in the Imperial Cult of the Virtues.

BRE
Know it all.

AIFE
The Gods granted man the gifts of Intelligence, Virtue and Fidelity.

BRE
If the Imperial Cult is so virtuous why did they murder all the druids?

BOUDICA
(whisper)
Change the subject please.

AIFE
Look, real-life Trinovante warriors!

Boudica turns.

SIX MEN AND TWO WOMEN stand beside a MEAD CART, they're huge, physically larger than the Iceni or Romans.

A fearsome sight, dressed in heavy pelts and straps, they have bare feet, carry daggers, swords and weapons, VIKINGS.

AIFE (CONT'D)
Why is their skin blue?

BRE
Indigo dye from the woad plant. See how the men shave their bodies.

Their skin is dyed light blue and hi-lighted with Celtic swirls and shapes with *woad.*

The Trinovante WOMAN stares at Boudica, they lock-eyes.

Boudica can't move, something primal, an energy between them. The street music plays.

The Trinovante Woman tosses her drink, crosses the market to Boudica, pausing a respectful few feet away. Boudica's daughters are terrified, the slaves back-away.

The Trinovante Woman is scarred, her skin dyed, arms over developed from weapons-training.

Boudica takes a deep-breath, gently nudging her daughters behind her back.

The Trinovante woman, CARTIMANDA, ever so slowly lowers-herself, her knee touching the muddy street. She drops her head to the ground ahead of Boudica.

CARTIMANDA
(whisper)
Bou - Di - Caa.

**The first time we have heard the name Boudica spoken.*

There's a roar of noise from her gang, they speak a Germanic language.

Cartimanda looks back, hissing an order, that's absolutely defiant. She's BOSS here. We do not understand her language but the last word is: **BOUDICA**!

Cartimanda's men's chuckles cease, they move forward...

...They all start to kneel silently in the street, stopping traffic. Weapons CLANK as they touch the cobbled muddy street. Heads lowered.

Crowds pause trying to watch what's happening.

BRE
What are they doing?

AIFE
What does Boudica mean?

SLAVE
(whisper)
She was a Trinovante Queen.

BRE
Mother is an Iceni Queen!

SLAVE
(whisper)
Your mother is a Trinovante who became an Iceni Queen. To these people that marks her more powerful than even the Roman Emperor.
(beat)
She's like a God to them!

A STORE-HOLDER has been listening.

STORE-HOLDER
Did your slave just talk ill of the Emperor?

Boudica looks at him.

BOUDICA
She meant nothing by it, she's just a slave.

STORE-HOLDER
Are you something special to these joke-barbarians. Vagrants who get fat on Roman tributes.

Cartimanda's eyes flicker with electricity at the insult.

BOUDICA
It would appear you know more than I, sir. I don't know who they are. Come along children!

The Store-holder places his hand on Boudica's shoulder.

STORE-HOLDER
(firmly)
Your slave made a disparaging remark about the Emperor.

BOUDICA
I'm sorry...

STORE-HOLDER
A Queen can afford to buy some wine, or the Roman Auxiliary may hear word of your slave's rebellious nature.

BOUDICA
You've really gone too far...

Boudica pulls away from him, she shields her children as she moves away.

Cartimanda reaches carefully for her SWORD hilt.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
We need to find your father.

STORE-HOLDER
Hey, you're not going anywhere. Find a Centurion!..

The Store-Holder reaches for Boudica.

Cartimanda STANDS, DRAWS, CUTS in one motion, severing the Store-Owner's extended-arm with her sword.

Screaming he drops to his knees clawing at his SEVERED FOREARM.

Cartimanda lunges again, her sword stopped-short deep in his neck.

He stops screaming. She wrenches it free and spins, striking at his neck from the other direction. LOPPING OFF his head...

...Which BOUNCES towards Boudica and her daughters.

Cartimanda's SPATTERED WITH BLOOD kicking the headless body away. Looks at Boudica. Shakes blood off her blade. She motions Boudica to leave, making a respectful "away" gesture.

Boudica huddles her daughters and slaves, leaving quickly.

Cartimanda yells at her group signaling, they jump onto waiting **horses**, knocking the crowd away from Boudica and her group. Then galloping away.

Cartimanda rears her horse onto it's hind-legs. Making eye contact with Boudica. She grinds her "blue-dyed" heels in the horse's flanks, galloping out of the market place.

21 EXT. OPPIDA ROMAN TRADING VILLAGE - CONTINUOUS 21

Boudica and her daughters run down alleyways, the slaves follow in a complete panic.

Ducking into a doorway, out of breath and gasping.

BOUDICA
I'm so very sorry you had to see that my babies.

AIFE
His head went thud, thud, thud.

BOUDICA
Don't mock the dead!

BRE
No, it went squelch, thud, thud, thud, squelch.

Looking at each other they giggle then laugh.

AIFE
Mother, that woman killed him so swiftly, like a farmer slicing barley-corn.

BRE
She killed him because he disrespected our mother.

AIFE
Have you ever seen such a woman?

BOUDICA
(to slave)
Can you get our cart?
(to daughters)
We should make haste to father.

SLAVE
If I could be so bold, ma'am, I suggest we leave town and return to the Crannog. There'll be talk and you're an easy target for a Roman patrol.

Boudica nods.

22 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - EVENING 22

Prasutagus finishes his meal, Boudica watches.

Ciarán stands in the doorway, watching the night.

The children sleep in the great-bed. Fires roar and animals sleep.

PRASUTAGUS
I was questioned by a Deputy Centurion of the Legio X Gemina, then a Centuriones Ordinarii, and then finally an ancient Primus Pilus of the Africa campaign with a leopard skin jerkin. To each of them I swore I knew nothing of this incident. And that my wife was a civil and gentle soul, a wonderful mother and a fine cook.

BOUDICA
I said and did nothing to provoke them. I promise you.

PRASUTAGUS
I negotiated and bargained more today and with more passion, than I have in years. It was really quite thrilling.
(beat)
However, I don't want to do it again. So, we should send the servants into town when you need something special, like a blue robe.
(beat)
Perhaps for the next year or so?

Prasutagus smiles and winks at her.

She takes his hands in hers across the table.

BOUDICA
What does it mean?

PRASUTAGUS
Boudica?

Boudica nods.

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
The Trinovante's Gods are from before the time of the druids. They have no written words, no tablets or temples.
(MORE)

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
Their Gods and goddesses are stories told around camp fires, dreamed about on mid-summer nights.

BOUDICA
Who was she?

PRASUTAGUS
They call them Furies, a warrior Goddess.

BOUDICA
Why me?

PRASUTAGUS
You've been my wife since you were young, and know precious little of your own people, my love. Yours is a noble and proud lineage. But it is the blood of barbarians drives your heart. What you have achieved for yourself incites and energizes them, fills them with hope.

BOUDICA
Is that a bad thing?

PRASUTAGUS
It is nothing, until it is something.
(beat)
It might scare the Romans. That's why it's better you stay here, avoid town and barbarians for a few weeks.

BOUDICA
Of course.

Boudica listens, smiles and nods, she takes his plate, leaving the table. He's left in thought.

23 EXT. WOODS - DAY 23

We are deep in the forest, green and lush, rich moss and Lichen hangs thick and alive from ancient oak trees.

A SMALL HERD OF DEER, with their buck, moves through the trees, they bolt at the sound of voices.

Ahead of ancient moss covered stone-works from the time of the druids, Boudica and her daughters swing WOODEN SWORDS.

Their three horses graze lazily nearby.

Prasutagus and Ciarán tie off their horses, watching the three girls swing their swords.

Prasutagus smiles, he looks at Ciarán, but Ciarán has a grim expression on his face.

PRASUTAGUS
Well, I've found my three warriors at last.

Boudica and her daughters are laughing and out of breath, from play-time.

BOUDICA
My king, how are you boys, intimidated by our skill?

CIARÁN
I'll be back at the Crannog, my liege.

PRASUTAGUS
Take my wild daughters with you, I need to talk with my queen!

Ciarán mounts, grim-faced, the girls mount up and they gallop away with him laughing.

BOUDICA
What's the matter with him?

PRASUTAGUS
Ciarán fought in many wars, and saw too many friends killed. For him laughter and the sword don't go hand in hand.

BOUDICA
The way that woman used her sword, it was so impressive. She attacked without hesitation.

PRASUTAGUS
I'm not sure I want my daughters to be like Trinovante Brigandes. Fighting, never trusting anyone. None of them live very long lives.

BOUDICA
To be able to defend oneself cannot be a bad thing.

PRASUTAGUS
You clearly have Trinovante blood in your veins woman. But use that ferocity in a thoughtful way, not a blood thirsty way. Use it to be the best queen possible.

Prasutagus looks around the OLD STONE EDIFICE, he lays his hand on what was once an ALTER.

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
When we were a forest dwelling people. This was the most sacred of worship places. In the time of the druids. Before the Caesers landed.

BOUDICA
You met the new governor, Catus Decianus. How is he?

PRASUTAGUS
He let us know he barely tolerates this land and the peoples in it. When he was attacked by Barbarians in Vindolanda he punished his own Legions for permitting the attack. Then he calls us *Brittunculi* to our faces.

BOUDICA
Little Britons?

PRASUTAGUS
He's a condescending, entitled snob. But I'll make him like me. We'll invite him to dinner and impress him with our refinement and allegiance to his Empire.

BOUDICA
You will, because you're the wisest and most tenacious leader this people have had, my king!

She kisses him, he doesn't respond at first, but then he has no choice. She opens the front of his tunic revealing his chest, kissing it.

Prasutagus smiles.

There is a flash of dark MOVEMENT in the trees amongst the rich moss.

Prasutagus lifts Boudica onto the alter, kissing her leg.

He hears the noise. His senses tingling, he swiftly reaches for his SWORD.

Boudica lifts his face kissing him, he looks to the trees.

The movement is a FACE, painted blue and wild. A SMALL OLD MAN.

Prasutagus draws the blade moving Boudica protectively behind him.

PRASUTAGUS
Announce yourself, stranger.
(to Boudica)
Get the horses, now.

The Blue Face stares at them, and then, ever so slowly, backs into the shadows of the ancient oak trees, disappearing.

As he vanishes the ENORMOUS DARK SHADOW OF A “FURIE” WOMAN with wild hair appears, as from a dark-black smoke, a sword raises in her hand and the *apparition* is gone.

Prasutagus sees the apparition behind Boudica, but says nothing.

PRASUTAGUS (CONT’D)
We should leave. These woods are too easy an ambush site for a king and his queen alone.

BOUDICA
To be continued, my King!

Prasutagus play-bites at her behind as she climbs onto the horse, laughing.

Prasutagus follows his wife into the saddle, taking one cautious look back, they gallop away.

24 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - EVENING 24

The fire pit roars, lighting the room. Their home is dogs, cats, children and cows nudging their way inside. A wonderful home, like something from a Bergman movie.

Boudica stands weaving her new blue checked material (tartan) at an upright loom, alongside both daughters and the two slaves. Each daughter works on a smaller loom.

Prasutagus embraces his daughters from behind.

PRASUTAGUS
What do we have here?

AIFE
It's for *Samhain*. It's a lighter material, and lighter colors, like the leaves that fall, when the air dries and the cold if *Imbolc* begins early.

PRASUTAGUS
And yours little one.

BRE
The color of fire flies and flames to keep me warm in Beltane and Lughnasa.

PRASUTAGUS
And yours my Queen?

BOUDICA
It will be a thick cloak to keep you warm against the frost in Samhain.

PRASUTAGUS
I like that pattern, it's very me. I have a gift for you, too. Come.

Boudica turns smiling.

25 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MAIN AREA - NIGHT 25

Boudica watches her husband across the table, as he smiles. Their daughters watch too. A CAT twirls its tail preening for the audience.

PRASUTAGUS
It's not really a gift from me. But a dowry gift from your late great father, when I asked for your hand in marriage. At the time I didn't know what to do with it. But as events of recent have proven. *It may well be possible to leave your origins, but your origins will never leave you.*

Prasutagus places a neatly wrapped BUNDLE OF SKINS ahead of Boudica.

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
Trini, I placed this away in the event that we might have a son. I still hope that we do, sincerest apologies my dearest daughters. No disrespect intended.

AIFE
None taken!

BRE
What is it? Oh mother, do unwrap it, come on!

BOUDICA
Thank you, Father. My King.

Boudica unwraps the bundle. Revealing a magnificently made BRONZE ANTENNAE SWORD.

PRASUTAGUS
It is for a youth, or powerful woman.
(beat)
This style is more ancient than my tribe or yours, it predates the druids and the Romans, and even Alexander the Greek. See how it feels in your hand, Trina, my queen.

Boudica smiles, the sword seems to HUM like an electric buzzer, she waves it, flashing in the firelight.

**A short, sleek and deadly Bronze Age antenna sword.*

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
See how alive it feels, like an extension of your own body. The ancient smiths used forgotten magic from the mountain mists when they forged blades like this. The God spell of the Earth itself lies woven within it's fiery depths. See how the color changes with the setting sun.

Boudica backs towards the fire pit, flashing the sword around, smiling.

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
It has accepted you. See how it's life resonates with yours, the vibration you feel in your hand is the sword itself. One doesn't find a blade like this, the sword finds you.

Boudica touches the blade against the WOODEN GATE POST. She turns and strikes, slicing the post in one blow.

The two girls YELP in delight, even Prasutagus is shocked, but Boudica is most surprised.

PRASUTAGUS (CONT'D)
Perhaps we rest the blade for now? I shall have Ciarán commission a leather scabbard for it if you like it?

BOUDICA
(still shocked at the power of the blade)
I love it.

Prasutagus reaches for the severed gate post, placing it on the table.

Boudica stands ahead of the fire, her silhouette flickering, blade in hand. Prasutagus stares at her for a moment.

Looking just like the giant black-smoke "Furie" in the woods.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
What are you staring at?

PRASUTAGUS
A premonition, perhaps?

BOUDICA
Good things I hope?

PRASUTAGUS
I will need the blade to fashion a scabbard.

Boudica, smiles, she whips the sword through the air quickly and with amazing skill, turning it in her hand, to offer the handle to her husband, he takes it, she pulls him close.

BOUDICA
It feels like a link to my ancestors.

PRASUTAGUS
It's just a sword.

Boudica kisses him on the lips.

BOUDICA
(whisper)
This should remain in wraps for our first son. No offense girls.

AIFE/BRE
None taken!

Boudica gently releases the sword to Prasutagus.

26 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORT - MORNING 26

Prasutagus and Boudica walk through the barley crop, as the cresting sun scorches the sky dark red and purple.

PRASUTAGUS
Red sky in the morning.

BOUDICA
It will be a good harvest.

PRASUTAGUS
A late harvest, Trina.

Prasutagus is concerned by the red sky, Boudica is not.

27 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORT - DAY 27

DOZENS of Prasutagus' men work the field, as horses draw carts stacked with Barley.

Boudica and his daughters play with hunting HOUNDS at the side of the field.

Prasutagus trots around the workers watching the progress from horseback, he waves to his wife across the fields.

28 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORT - NIGHT 28

A banquet for all the workers, fires burn, and tables are dressed with a feast as TWO DOZEN workers, slaves and soldiers eat and laugh.

On the fortifications GUARD FIRES BURN as men stand watch.

The Hound-dogs and cats eat their share of spilled food.

The cows watch, the fires reflected in their bovine eyes.

Boudica feeds FEREL HOGS IN THREE CAGES and then walks through the crowds and enters the main building.

29 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - STORAGE AREA - NIGHT 29

Boudica approaches Prasutagus, who stands alone looking at his stacked crops.

BOUDICA
You should eat and be thankful, your people are asking after you.
(beat)
But...

PRASUTAGUS
The anticipation, the challenge and then to have it go so well. Exactly as planned. Make an excuse for me, I'll join you when my mood improves, my love.

BOUDICA
Of course.

Boudica leaves.

She's suspicious and looks back into the storage room.

Prasutagus talks to the DRUID from the forest, he's small and dyed blue and wild haired. He looks right at Boudica and she leaves, when Prasutagus turns, Boudica is gone.

30 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MAIN AREA - NIGHT 30

A large fire burns in the hearth and food cooks, there's more than ample food hanging and drying from the ceiling. The home is a hive of activity as usual.

The DAUGHTERS giggle and play with friends, dressing up and putting on a SHOW.

31 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORTIFICATION - CONTINUOUS 31

A fire burns in the grate on the wall. A GUARD watches the mist that cloaks the horizon.

OS SOUND: ARMOR CLANKING, MARCHING FEET.

LANTERNS AND FLAMES light the mist as SILHOUETTES appear.

From the mist appears a ROMAN LEGION of 100 MEN strong, HORSE MOUNTED CAVALRY outriders.

The GUARD calls a warning.

32 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORT - NIGHT 32

The Roman Soldiers stand to attention, and the cavalry watch as a dignitary, CATUS DECIANUS, steps out of his carved-wood horse-drawn CARRIAGE.

Like his entourage he's draped in wolf-fur against the cold.

GUARDS, DOGS AND HAND-MAIDs, a splendid entrance.

Prasutagus and Boudica stand alongside their ENTIRE HOUSEHOLD to welcome the visiting dignitary.

Catus Decianus, pauses 10ft from Prasutagus.

Prasutagus must break ranks and move to Catus Decianus to kiss his ring. A show of power.

Catus smiles at Boudica.

33 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MAIN AREA - NIGHT 33

Bre sings a Roman song, it's sweet, lovely.

Unlike the rest of the room, Prasutagus doesn't eat, he watches Catus.

Catus eats as he listens to the child sing.

Boudica watches Prasutagus watching Catus.

Bre wraps it up to cheers and clapping.

BOUDICA
She pleased you, no?

CATUS
Dare I presume to ask whether she has a Roman tutor?

BOUDICA
Of course. He was highly recommended, and expensive.

CATUS
I knew, I told you Maximus, I told you they had Roman tutors for their children.
(beat)
In Africa I witnessed a dancing monkey that had been schooled by a Roman Tutor, they're the best in the world. They can teach anyone the basics of culture, even barbarian children.

Boudica bristles, if Catus notices he doesn't show it. Prasutagus reaches for Boudica's hand, calming her.

PRASUTAGUS
How long do you wish to grace us with your presence, Lord?

CATUS
Perhaps a year, maybe two...

Catus smiles.

CATUS (CONT'D)
...We leave in the morning, you need only feed my small entourage from your supplies for tonight and a small breakfast. Don't worry, we won't clean you out, my *Brittunculi* friend.

He doesn't even look at Prasutagus.

PRASUTAGUS
You are quite welcome to stay as long as you wish. It is my honor to host you.

CATUS
Yes, yes it is.

Catus pushes his plate away, burping loudly, swallowing a mouthful of wine.

CATUS (CONT'D)
You built this fort, Prasutagus?

PRASUTAGUS
It's a holding handed down within my family. I improved on it and will maintain it for the next generation.

CATUS
Then your family stole it from someone?

PRASUTAGUS
Bought it, traded, or won it. My ancestors had a reputation for avoiding violence when necessary, I try to carry on that tradition.

BOUDICA
My King is the personification of civilization in this land.

Catus glances at Boudica.

Then looks around the great hall.

CATUS
A bed-rock foundation. Arable land, that you til and keep fertile with the manure of the beast who graze here. You have a rich soil that could support a steeper motte if one were inclined to build. A soil that doesn't get damp, and the elevation causes a water run off and down hill mitigation.
(beat)
The view is uninhibited in every direction. On a good day you can see the Watling road I hazard?

PRASUTAGUS
You're correct.

CATUS
If only you had a water supply?

Catus looks at Prasutagus and then Boudica, who are silent.

CATUS (CONT'D)
But you do have a water supply, don't you? Oh goodness, you have your own spring. So not poison-able by an enemy laying siege. No wonder this has been a desirable fort for millennia, my little King. A consistent humidity and temperature because of the elevation. I bet you have storage for grain and dried goods, too?

PRASUTAGUS
Yes.

Catus fixes his look on Prasutagus, it's a stare.

CATUS
A *basse-cour*, around a raised *castellum*. Either through trial and error, or design, your architects did well, Prasutagus. It's a fine fort, easily on a par with one I requisitioned for myself in Africa.

BOUDICA
We serve you well, here, Lord.

CATUS
Yes, you do.

Catus eats. Prasutagus has lost his appetite.

CATUS (CONT'D)
Eat, eat, my dear Briton king, I'm not going to take your fort. I apprenticed in architecture in Rome, I possess a layman's interest in masonry and such arts.

Prasutagus is not convinced, but eats.

34 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORTIFICATION - MORNING 34

Prasutagus and Ciarán watch the Roman convoy leave down the road. The FORTIFICATION GATES are closed and shored up.

Boudica watches and listens at their side.

CIARÁN
I know that we benefit from their wealth, trade and authority. But, I don't like them.

PRASUTAGUS
We're going to have to be very well behaved Britons. This officious bastard could royally fuck us if he chose to.

CIARÁN
May I speak to you privately.

PRASUTAGUS
Anything you have to say, she can hear.

CIARÁN
There are men, in our employ my king, who know certain types that would, for a bounty, find a way to ensure that he didn't wake up from his sleep.

PRASUTAGUS
And if they fail? The Romans will torture a man to the point of betraying his own parents. It's easier to be smart, well behaved and make ourselves indispensable.

CIARÁN
You're right of course.

PRASUTAGUS
Have the guard ready to leave, we'll run raiding parties for a few days. Round up some bandits, Goths, undesirables. We'll send them to Catus Decianus as a tribute. Knowing this land is dangerous might temper his desire to settle here.

CIARÁN
You're a wise man, my lord.

PRASUTAGUS
I'll ride with the party, the exercise will do me good.

Ciarán leaves to prepare the raiding party.

35 EXT. RIVER - DAY 35

Prasutagus up to his chest naked in the river water, washing.

Boudica swims under-water to his side, she appears ahead of him, also naked.

BOUDICA
May a Queen join her King?

PRASUTAGUS
So lucky to have you, so cursed to have to leave you.

BOUDICA
Washing before the journey not after?

PRASUTAGUS
Centering my mind, my only light.

BOUDICA
Can I help center you?

Boudica kisses him passionately.

PRASUTAGUS
I'll be late...

BOUDICA
You'll have to ride hard.

PRASUTAGUS
I'll be late to leave?

BOUDICA
As long as it's you in the saddle.

PRASUTAGUS
Then I can be late.

BOUDICA
You are King, you can be whatever you like.

They make love.

36 EXT. RIVER - DAY 36

They lie together in bed.

PRASUTAGUS
I'm very late. You make me forget all my duties.

BOUDICA
Who was the druid?

Prasutagus pauses, smiling.

PRASUTAGUS
Nothing gets past you, does it?

BOUDICA
Is there anything I should know?

PRASUTAGUS
I pray to Roman Gods, I pay tributes to Roman temples. My daughters learn Latin and my people respect Roman traditions. I am a good and loyal subject.

BOUDICA
Then why risk us?

PRASUTAGUS
My land and people are simpler than I am, there are no books. It's their way and I am their King, so I must know it and respect it.

BOUDICA
I trust you. But if I know, then others do, too.

PRASUTAGUS
You're right. When I return I will order him meet only on his lands. You're wise, my Trina.

Boudica smiles, gently mounting him again, kissing him.

BOUDICA
Must you leave so soon?

37 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MAIN AREA - MORNING 37

OS: SHOUTING, SCREAMING, MUFFLED FIGHTING, objects crashing.

An armed GUARD draws his sword and lunges for the door.

Ciarán stops him, a dangerous looking blade held to his neck.

GUARD
The king's in danger!

CIARÁN
You're new aren't you?

GUARD
I'm son of the cousin Dafydd of Cymru.

CIARÁN
The only danger our noble king faces are the claws of his queen.

They stand listening as the sounds of the fight become a more rhythmic knocking, Boudica's gasping in time with the knocks.

Ciarán removes his blade from the Guards neck, smiles.

GUARD
It sounded like they were killing each other.

CIARÁN
Yes it did.

GUARD
I'm sorry.

CIARÁN
You're a good Icini boy, watch out for those Trinovante girls. They'll either kill you on the field or in the bedroom.

38 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MAIN AREA - MORNING 38

Prasutagus and Boudica lie exhausted, soaked in sweat and entangled in bed sheets and pelts.

The sleeping area's wrecked, furs are strewn around the floor, a shattered clay pot holding bronze and steel weapons has scattered over the floor.

Prasutagus limps naked to the water trough and submerges his upper body in it, gasping as he emerges.

PRASUTAGUS
Ciarán, is the raiding party ready to leave?

From behind a door Ciarán answers immediately.

CIARÁN
Saddled and ready to leave my lord.

PRASUTAGUS
(to Boudica)
Will I ever grow tired of your magical embrace, my Queen? My thirst for you! A dryness in my soul, that only you can quench.

The two GIRLS charge in screaming and shouting, playing, followed by the HOUNDS and the NURSE.

GIRLS
Mummy, Daddy!

Prasutagus laughs loudly as does Boudica, embracing her daughters.

BOUDICA
School is over I assume?

Prasutagus picks up both girls, one under each arm and spins with them, they scream and shout, kicking and laughing.

He rolls into the huge bed with them, and stands wrapping himself in his garments, grabbing his sword.

Kneels beside Boudica and kisses her on the mouth.

PRASUTAGUS
Stay warm for me, my queen, we'll continue this soon!

BOUDICA
I promise, my king!

They look at each other outside of the embrace, breaking away.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Take me...

Prasutagus wraps skins around his shoulders.

PRASUTAGUS
What?

BOUDICA
Take me with you.

Prasutagus body language changes.

PRASUTAGUS
Not this time. Know I love you, have always, and aways will.

Prasutagus leaves without looking back.

Ciarán looks back briefly as he meets his King, catching Boudica's eye.

Boudica watches him, a chill comes over her and she shivers, the room falls magically silent and her smile fades.

39 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORTIFICATION 39

Morning to day and then night, the moon over the house.

40 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - EVENING 40

Boudica has a thick wolf skin around her shoulders, the Hounds at her side, she watches the sky. Her two daughters do their embroidery.

Ciarán and five warriors move up behind her.

Boudica turns looking back at them.

Their facial expressions say everything.

BOUDICA
What, what has happened?

Ciarán has been crying he looks down unable to make eye contact.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Tell me at once, what has happened?

Boudica stands grabbing at Ciarán and hitting him.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Why aren't you talking, what is the matter?

CIARÁN
He's dead, my queen. Murdered.

Boudica attacks Ciarán, and has to be untangled from the Warrior, who refuses to defend himself, his face is cut.

Boudica collapses to the ground, the warriors move to help her and knocks one down.

The girls stand watching.

GIRLS
Mummy?

BOUDICA
You fucking bastards are alive and he's dead, you are his bodyguard his sentinels, why aren't you dead?

Ciarán talks but, Boudica hears nothing, folding over, her forehead to the ground, in a silent scream.

She stands, looking them fiery eyed.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Get out, go away, get out of my house!

Ciarán nods backing away, his warriors follow him.

CIARÁN
I'll leave a praetorian guard outside the main wall.

BOUDICA
I don't give a fuck, just get your vile faces away from me and out of my house.

Boudica lifts the wolf skin and takes her daughters inside the great house.

41 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORTIFICATION - DAY 41

Boudica's INAUGURATION CELEBRATION. She's being crowned overall Queen. Maypole dancers, crowds, food and dancers of every kind perform.

Boudica is steely eyed and cold.

Her two daughters at her side, sensitive to her feelings, now less childlike.

Catus arrives with a detachment of grim-faced Legionnaires.

The laughter stops, a SILENCE falls on the festivities.

Catus bows to Boudica, who nods, he approaches and kisses her ring.

CATUS
Hail, Queen Boudica.

BOUDICA
Hail, Catus Decianus. Please sit with me.

Catus looks at her, he smiles.

CATUS
I will remain standing, I don't intend to stay long, it's abundantly clear my presence is a weight on the mood of the locals.

BOUDICA
You read too much of simple curiosity. Did you receive my tribute?

CATUS
I did, I did, thank you. You betrothed me half of all your holdings and land, a more than generous acquiescence.

BOUDICA
I am glad his lordship is satisfied.

CATUS
I have said much, but I didn't say that.

Boudica looks at him for the first time.

CATUS (CONT'D)
I just cannot accept your tribute. I cannot take half of your lands and holdings, I came here in person to tell you so. It would be wrong, immoral and without virtue befitting a man such as myself.

BOUDICA
You are a surprise, my Lord.

CATUS
As a woman, the Roman Empire cannot and will not acknowledge you as queen. We don't recognize a female as worthy of any kind of governing power. To do so is a crime against the senate, Rome and the Empire, not to mention an indignity to the Emperor himself.
(beat)
That a female tribeswoman would take it on herself to think she could bequeath a percentage of her lands to Rome in an effort to try to convince them to turn a blind eye to this wanton ridicule of Roman laws is a travesty of justice and a crime that begs to be punished to the fullest.

BOUDICA
I don't understand you.

CATUS
I'll make it simple for your barbarian brain to ingest. I cannot accept half your kingdom, so I will be taking your whole kingdom. You will be whipped, and your punishment shared with your daughters as you watch. Anyone that attempts to stop us will be executed on the spot.

Boudica glances at Ciarán.

CATUS (CONT'D)
You look to Ciarán, the same man who informed us of your husband's location on the day he was killed.

Boudica looks daggers at Ciarán, who clearly wasn't expecting to be thrown under the bus. His praetorian guard reel, weapons at the ready.

CATUS (CONT'D)
Stand down! I am your governor in the name of Emperor Nero of the Roman Empire, my word is law as I speak for the Emperor himself. This land and all that was formerly of King Prasutagus of Icini, is now mine.

Boudica, is seized by ROMAN SOLDIERS. Dragged from her throne.

Silence. Only images.

Horrified Briton subjects.

Boudica is knocked to the ground. Bleeding, her wrists are tied and she's hoisted from a beam. A CAT'O'NINE TAILS WHIP revealed, her toes are lifted off the ground.

Her two screaming daughters are seized by Roman soldiers.

Ciarán watches, he doesn't appear to take any pleasure in it.

Boudica screams from her soul, in sheer abject horror, we hear nothing. A Centurion whips her.

45 seconds of black screen - just sound effects and dialogue.

Boudica's bound, bloody, and exhausted, her head hangs limp.

Catus stands very close to her, he whispers.

CATUS (CONT'D)
You must understand our Emperor murdered his own mother.
(beat)
I knew Julia Agrippina, she was a difficult woman, but, she was his mother. She tried to play regent, and so she was poisoned. Then there was the Empress Claudia Octavia, Julia's daughter. Nero had her veins opened and her head removed and sent to Poppaea Sabina. In such light I believe I have been generous on his behalf.

An IRON BRAND is heated in fiery coals. The brand steams and pops as it is withdrawn from the coals.

CATUS (CONT'D)
Our emperor gave me this gift as a warning to stay loyal. You heat it with fire and touch it to the face of any slave who misbehaves. They are marked as his property, N-R, *Nero rex-drusus*.

The Centurion approaches Boudica who sees the glowing brand. Held firm by THREE SOLDIERS, one arm-locks her head.

CATUS (CONT'D)
In your case the N-R might stand for *Nec Regina*, no queen.
(beat)
Any rebellious *Brittunculi* that look to you will laugh when they see your face and will be reminded of your falsehood.

The Brand is touched against her cheek, hissing, the pain is unbearable, she kicks, recoiling upwards and then faints.

Catus takes a deep breath.

CATUS (CONT'D)
The so illicit perfume of burned human flesh.

42 EXT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE FORTIFICATION - NIGHT 42

A wooden cage.

Boudica's covered in mud, blood and sweat, her clothing torn and ruined, sleeping, huddled against the cold and rain.

A ROMAN SOLDIER stands guard, an animal skin drenched wet around his shoulders.

A SHADOW appears behind him, fingers grab his steel helmet, wrenching his chin up. A Trinovante warrior, DANIELA cuts his throat, blood streams into the rain.

His sword and pelts are removed, then his helmet.

The leather ties holding the cage are sliced open.

Hands grab at Boudica who kicks back terrified.

CARTIMANDA touches her lips “shhhh.”

Boudica’s swollen eyes are wild, her brand oozing blood.

They slide down a wet slope, through mud, until splashing quietly into a fast running stream.

Boudica gasps, Cartimanda holds her tight, they float through the water, with several other RAIDERS.

At the wall, TWO MORE ROMAN SOLDIERS lie sprawled in the mud, throats cut, armor removed. Daniela, spattered with blood, joins the raiding party in the stream.

The party slips through the shredded guard that once stopped raiders entering through the water.

43 EXT. MOORS - NIGHT 43

The raiding party crawls from the water, into knee high grass. Moving quickly on land their breath steam, Boudica trips, Daniela helps her to her feet.

DANIELA
Be strong.

Clothes are retrieved from a HIDDEN CACHE. Cartimanda strips ahead of Boudica, dressing in dry clothing. Reaching for Boudica’s torn Royal garments, Boudica knocks her hand-away.

Boudica’s nervous, face swollen. Cartimanda gently touches her clothing, shaking her head. Points back at the Romans.

Boudica in blur, watches her daughters dress.

AIFE
These are boy clothes.

The girls change their clothes.

BRE
Why does she want us to wear boys clothes?

AIFE
Are we disguising ourselves, Mother?

BOUDICA
Do as she says.

The girls look at each other, dressing as Trinovante boys. Boudica's voice weak and strained, near exhaustion.

Boudica strips off her torn dress, revealing her back to Cartimanda, skin SLASHED AND CUT from the whipping.

Cartimanda gently presses a compress of herbs into Boudica's back, laying a thin cloth over the wound.

Daniela daubs white clay into the Boudica's hair.

Boudica's bruised face is painted half white. Cartimanda looks at Boudica, nose to nose, into her eyes.

CARTIMANDA
(whisper)
Do not die!

The two girls faces are painted *woad* blue, they watch.

The raiding party hikes through the night. Boudica supported by Cartimanda, the daughters follow alone behind the crowd.

Tiny dots on a hillside, sun rising behind the Northern hill country, dark clouds above her swirl and broil.

44 EXT. TRINOVANTE CAMP - DAY 44

Over black: we hear the sound of Trinovante-camp-life, laughing, chattering, farm animals.

Brilliant winter light in vivid shafts through the wood hut.

Boudica wakes, painfully weak, malnourished.

Sitting up. Daniela watches her closely.

Exhausted, her wounds are still swollen, have been dressed and cared for.

Boudica looks around the room, then outside to the source of the laughter.

Her daughters watch Cartimanda, she's rounding up GEESE, it's difficult and funny.

Boudica doesn't smile.

Cartimanda feels her look.

Daniela offers a LADLE OF WATER.

BOUDICA
My daughters are laughing?

Daniela doesn't appear to understand.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
They're not in pain, any nightmares?

Daniela shakes her head. Offering the water again.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
They're young they don't understand what happened, they must heal.

Daniela peels off the layer of light cotton that covers Boudica's back, gently rubs in more medicine.

Boudica gasps in pain.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
What will become of us, here? How will I feed my children? I cannot live off your charity.

Daniela takes Boudica's hand, then lowers her head, and drops to her knees, holding Boudica's hand on her head.

Boudica tries to move her hand, the warrior holds it firm.

She looks up slowly at Boudica.

DANIELA
You are Queen. We are your children. Boudica.

Boudica takes her hand away. The significance of what she's heard resonates.

Her two daughters come rushing into the room, laughing they pause on seeing her, she looks weak and isn't smiling.

Cartimanda enters, dismissing Daniela.

AIFE
Mother.

BRE
They have geese and ducks and sheep. They're ever so kind and have been wonderful to us.

Boudica takes a second. Reaching her arms into an embrace.

BOUDICA
Children...

Boudica embraces her daughters looking at Cartimanda who doesn't react.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
How are my two kittens?

The children back off. Aife sits at the Warrior's side, Cartimanda starts to comb the Boudica's hair gently.

***Cartimanda NEVER takes her eyes off Boudica, never looks, or pays attention to the children.**

BRE
We've been discussing it, mother. The Trinovante have let us know too. We must do something.

BOUDICA
(smiling)
What must we do?

AIFE
We must kill the Romans, mother. All of them.

BOUDICA
Where did this come from?

BRE
She's right, mother, we simply must kill all of the Romans. For the Trinovante, for the Icini and for father.

AIFE
She is their sooth-sayer, she can see the future. She said you are to be queen. That your first task is to kill Romans. That we will help you.

Boudica's doesn't recognize the two little warriors.

Trinovante men carry in a PLATE of meat and fruit.

Cartimanda implies Boudica should eat.

Boudica eats, chewing is painful. She THROWS UP.

45 INT. TRINOVANTE CAMP HUT - DAY 45

Boudica lies on her front, as ointment is massaged into her back. Thin cotton laid on her, pressed and bandaged.

Boudica stands, watching outside.

46 EXT. RIVER - CONTINUOUS 46

Cartimanda stands in the river with Boudica's daughters she use a bow to hunt, both daughters mimic her with miniature bows. The Warrior reels in a small fish.

The daughters laughing and joking, gleefully impressed.

Boudica stands at rivers edge.

BOUDICA
What are you learning.

BRE
She teaches us how to use their weapons.

BOUDICA
Must a Trinovante woman fight?

AIFE
Trinovante women do everything. Most of all they fight.

BOUDICA
Can I spend some time with you my dears, it feels like I've seen nothing of you?

Cartimanda nods and leaves.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
She has looked after you well.

AIFE
She's our friend, mother.

BOUDICA
Why?

AIFE
She is a mother too.

BOUDICA
Where are her children?

AIFE
The Romans killed her children, she had daughters, like us. Everyone here is the same, they have been hurt by the Romans, or their families murdered.

BOUDICA
Isn't it dangerous being together like this?

AIFE
They say the Romans don't come this far north.

BRE
These people want you to be their queen. They say you were chosen, it's an honor.

BOUDICA
I wasn't chosen, I was double crossed and betrayed. My people let this happen.

BRE
No, they mean that Catus chose you. When he branded you, he gave you no choice.

Bre touches Boudica's scarred cheek.

BOUDICA
A mark of humiliation.

BRE
They can't spell, they don't use writing. To the Trinovante you have been anointed.

BOUDICA
What do you little monsters think?

AIFE
You are their Queen, we are your princesses, our duty is to bring the tribes together to kill Romans.

BOUDICA
So you're really not going to discuss it with me.

BRE
Do you remember what the Roman soldiers did to us? What Catus ordered his men to do. In front of your friends and family. Your tiny children.

BOUDICA
I'm so sorry, I'm so, so sorry, my babies.

BRE
They tied you up and whipped you until your skin was hanging off your bones, then they branded you like an animal. You were the Queen of the Icini. You are still the Queen of the Icini.

AIFE
The Trinovante gave us a way to mend.

BRE
We've become warriors, you must join us, mother.

The two girls stand completely still, unblinking, they stare at their mother.

It's obvious they have changed a lot. She looks at them, standing waste deep in the river, not sure whether to be scared, or proud of them.

BOUDICA
I think it's all a bit much for me.

BRE
In time you will get used to it. First thing is these people need you as their Queen.

AIFE
You really have no choice.

47 EXT. TRINOVANTE CAMP - MORNING 47

Boudica swings a WOODEN SWORD in training combat with a MALE TRINOVANTE WARRIOR, who coaches Boudica through movements. The sticks bash. Her two daughters watch.

Boudica is studying hard, she's sweating. The Warrior points to a wooden DUMMY, showing Boudica where to cut.

TRAINER
Neck, kidneys, wrists! Stomach won't kill, but will stop, that's where most wear their armor thickest. Neck, under the arms, Kidneys, those three will become your targets.

Cartimanda arrives. Hands a package to Boudica. Boudica opens it: The BRONZE TRINOVANTE SWORD that her husband gave her.

BOUDICA
Where did you find this?

The Warrior speaks to the Trainer in her own tongue.

TRAINER
She says, Catus traded off all Prasutagus' property, she stole this. It's an old style.

CARTIMANDA
I stole it... For you...

Boudica starts to cry. She kneels down holding the sword.

AIFE
Don't cry mother, we can't show weakness.

The Warrior holds Boudica's shoulder.

TRAINER
Bronze is the metal of the past, it doesn't hold an edge. It's heavy and unwieldily, more dangerous to the owner than the enemy.

WOLFGAR
(shouting)
Who is using my training area?

WOLFGAR is a Trinovante Warrior, he has FIFTEEN WARRIORS with him. These are fighters, and look terrifying. The Warrior Woman looks nervous. Boudica stands.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
You're the Icini Queen that the witch told us about.

TRAINER
They call her Boudica.

WOLFGAR
A bold name.

BOUDICA
I did not choose it.

Wolfgar gently turns her face with his HUGE hand, examining the brand on her cheek.

WOLFGAR
Catus made a mess of your face and I've seen what the cat of nine tails does to a man's back. But, how does that qualify you to lead the Trinovante? Why should you be leader and not me?

BOUDICA
I have not accepted any title, I am just Boudica.

BRE
You will never be just Boudica.

WOLFGAR
I have returned from my travels, to pitch my case as leader. You would be advised to step aside.

Wolfgar's men are growing impatient to train. Wolfgar looks at the Bronze sword.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
You expect to fight Romans with this, they were no use when that was all we had. Steel, iron, that's the way of modern warfare. May I?

Boudica hands him the ancient Bronze sword.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Fuck, it's ugly in hand, heavy imbalanced. No life to it.

He swings, cutting a chunk of wood, then again, he moves swiftly and with great precision. Splinters erupt. His attack is devastating compared to Boudica's training.

He feels the edge of the blade after the attack.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Eight or ten blows and the edge is dulled. That's why we don't use Bronze anymore. Let me do you a favor.

Wolfgar bends the sword and throws it into the river.

Cartimanda and Boudica's two daughters watch open mouthed.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
What? I did her a favor.

Boudica turns and walks to the river, she drops her clothing and dives in naked.

She's under water a long-time.

A crowd assembles at the rivers edge.

BRITON
Where is she?

WOLFGAR
That sword was shit. Any real warrior would know that.

BRITON
No one can hold their breath that long.

TRAINER
There are under water currents here that will hold a grown-man down against the sandy bottom and drown him.

WOLFGAR
You're a ray of sunshine aren't you?

TRAINER
I lost my dog in that river.

WOLFGAR
Should I go in, I feel responsible?

Behind them...

BOUDICA
Whats so interesting?

Boudica is soaked, she drops her white under-dress over herself, the crowd turns to face her.

She has the now-straightened bronze sword in her hand. Looking like a pre-Raphaelite painting.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Perhaps the sword chooses who it performs for.

TRAINER
How did you re-shape the blade?

Boudica walks towards the WOODEN SWORD DUMMY.

WOLFGAR
This should be interesting. Don't hurt yourself, skinny!

Boudica looks at the dummy, she weighs the bronze sword in her hand, it HUMS, as if it was VIBRATING slightly.

A CROWD has gathered.

She strikes the wooden dummy, the Bronze sword SLICES the wood cleanly FOUR TIMES with a SUCKING/CLEAVING sound. A magical display. Even Boudica seems surprised.

Wolfgar stands open mouthed. The FIFTEEN Warriors with him are silent. The Trainer and Cartimanda are open mouthed wide eyed. Her two daughters are speechless.

The last log-sized slice of dummy drops to the ground.

Boudica swings the small Bronze sword it TWIRLS and locks in her wrist with a BUZZING, RING. Alive, Magical and like nothing any of these people have EVER seen.

The moment hangs, a looooooong-beat.

Wolfgar picks up a severed lump of wood. Laughs and whistles. His men all laugh. Impressed.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
I was a mercenary in Judea, a tracker for the Spanish legions of Augustus, a swordsman for rome. In all my years living by the sword, I've never seen anything like that before.
(beat)
I was wrong.
(MORE)

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Not only do you look like a Warrior Queen, but this strange old sword is more befitting a royal hand than any weapon I've laid eyes on.

Wolfgar kneels. He signals to his men who follow suit. As does the Trainer, and all gathered.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
My people need a leader. We asked the Gods of the land to provide one, and they have answered! Queen Boudica. Accept me and my men as your loyal servants.

Boudica looks over the kneeling warriors. She's serious, understanding what this means.

48 EXT. RIVER - EVENING 48

Boudica watches the still water.

Cartimanda sits beside her silently.

Boudica looks at her and nervously laughs, they both laugh.

BOUDICA
You knew this was going to be complicated all along, didn't you?

Cartimanda just smiles and nods.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
I was happy being a collaborator, I was happy being a wife. Now those two girls are the only trace of the old me.

Cartimanda is cold-faced.

49 INT. TRINOVANTE CAMP HUT - NIGHT 49

The room is filled with trinovante men, who sit on the floor, and stand, they all look at Boudica. She and her daughters are all three dressed in Trinovante plaid (tartan.)

Boudica's hair has grown long and wild, it is some time after the sword incident.

BRE
It's all right mother, they don't mean to scare you, they love you.

Room is completely packed, no light can enter for the steaming human mass.

An ANCIENT TRINOVANTE sits opposite Boudica.

He carefully places a golden TOUC ahead of Boudica.

ANCIENT
(in Trinovante tongue)
It was your symbol of royalty. When you wear it you shall be Queen. Do you choose the royal touc, Boudica?

BRE
Put it on, mother.

AIFE
Do try it on, it's so beautiful.

Boudica looks at her daughters. Placing the touc on her neck, it covers her neck entirely in gold.

The room erupts into cheers.

Boudica smiles, but the implications are deep.

Wolfgar watches Boudica smiling.

BOUDICA
What do you say, brave Wolfgar?

WOLFGAR
You're a fine figurehead around which to gather enough fighting men to challenge the Romans.

Boudica doesn't like this.

BOUDICA
You think I'm just a figurehead?

WOLFGAR
What do you mean, of course you are, I don't mean to insult you. It's a fine thing to be our tribe's figurehead. There's nothing wrong with it.

BOUDICA
Fuck you.

WOLFGAR
Excuse me?

BOUDICA
You're a goat fucker, Wolfgar! You talk a good talk when you're strengthened by a gut full of honey mead, but you're no fucking warrior leader.

Silence, even Boudica's daughters look at her shocked.

WOLFGAR
What do you know of my wars, what could you possibly know. You're a fucking house wife.

Boudica stands.

BOUDICA
I know enough to know fear when I see it. You're scared to engage the Romans. You've backed me to evade the task of leading a resistance yourself. You're a snake.

WOLFGAR
You know nothing of me, you foul mouthed cunt. It was my backing you that made you.

The room looks back to Boudica.

BOUDICA
How many men were in your army when you stormed the white castle in Africa.

WOLFGAR
I had one hundred and fifty or more.

BOUDICA
You had sixty five Celts and twenty eastern mercenaries.

WOLFGAR
I did.

BOUDICA
How many men did it take to sack the North African throne of Emperor Septimo.

WOLFGAR
Those were ex-legion, they were the best fighting men in the world and freshly experienced they could have led themselves.

BOUDICA
How many did it take?

WOLFGAR
They were Legio Patria Nostra, of the Regent Tiberius, they were armed and lived for war, they had fought against Emperor Claudio and the future Emperor Vespasian at the battle for Camulos.

BOUDICA
(roaring like a lion)
Just answer the question you fucking maggot, how many men did you have?

WOLFGAR
Fifty five and fourteen weapons wranglers and spear men, horses and wolves.

Boudica smiles. She’s possessed powerful. Unintimidated.

BOUDICA
We have almost a hundred fighting men here we will have five hundred by next week, a thousand in a month. Many of them experienced. If you won’t lead this army against the Romans, then I will.

WOLFGAR
You have no experience and besides they wouldn’t follow you.

BOUDICA
Why won’t they follow me, Wolfgar?

WOLFGAR
Do I need to answer such an obvious question?

BOUDICA
Why won’t my army follow their queen into battle?

WOLFGAR
You're a woman.

Boudica looks at Wolfgar.

She turns to the room, of silently breathless spectators.

BOUDICA
We know Governor Catus Decianus is headed North through the Fallbrook forest. This is the perfect avenue for an ambush. Terrain we are familiar with, in a battle the Romans are least equipped for.

WOLFGAR
Catus Decianus has a centurie of 80 men of the second Augusta Legion marching with him at all times, along with mounted Equites and Saxon mercenaries. He will destroy any ambush you set.

BOUDICA
If we don't strike now, then when brave Wolfgar? Right now our cause is strongest and our virtue righteous. You've been under occupation for twenty years and have nothing to show for it.

WOLFGAR
We must plan a war!

BOUDICA
If you're not behind me at Fallbrook forest then I'll fight Catus alone. But I will fight him.

WOLFGAR
You're mad as a fucking March hare.

BOUDICA
I'm quite clear headed, Wolfgar, as clear headed as I have ever been. I need to know if you're with me?

Boudica doesn't wait for his answer, turning on her heel.

The room watches her as she stops at the entrance way, her back to the crowd.

Boudica looks to her daughters.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Get me my sword.

The two girls fetch her Bronze sword.

But what the room sees is the SWORD FLOATING across the great hall, and into Boudica's hand

For the first time we realize ONLY Boudica can see her daughters. She grasps the sword.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Thank you.

Boudica puts the sword into her belt and leaves.

WOLFGAR
Was I the only one who fucking saw that?

CARTIMANDA
It has been that way, she talks to them, but no one else sees them.

WARRIOR
They were savaged by roman soldiers when she was whipped, they died, she lived.

WOLFGAR
Savaged?

TRINOVANTE WARRIOR
Raped, murdered and soiled ahead of a crowd of Celts who remained silent. Watching as she was whipped until the flesh hung from her bones.

WOLFGAR
Our world is a series of signs. Messages from the sun, the moon, the stars, the oceans and the night. Our Queen is blessed by the Heavens, if she says today is the day, then today it is.

Wolfgar takes a breath.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
If you are with me, gather your weapons, rations for three days, we leave with our queen. Fuck, we may have to run to catch up with her.

50 EXT. ROMAN ROAD TO FALLBROOK FOREST - DAY 50

Boudica walks beside her daughters, Cartimanda behind her. The golden *touc* around Boudica's neck reflects the sun.

BOUDICA
You don't approve?

AIFE
We said nothing.

They walk a little further.

BOUDICA
Your silence speaks volumes.

AIFE
You acted willfully. You ask a lot of a simple people.

BOUDICA
When opportunity presents itself we must seize it. Catus in the forest is an opportunity. Did I do wrong?

AIFE
You should not act so willfully again. In future you will have generals and advisors to consult.

BOUDICA
Do you think I will have to fight Catus alone?

BRE
Look behind you mother.

Boudica and Cartimanda appear to stand alone on the straight Roman road.

She looks back, pausing.

The road's empty.

Boudica turns focusing.

The noise of a small army approaching.

Movement, a cloud of dust.

Marching quickly are the MEN AND WARRIORS of Wolfgar and a HUNDRED or more, Britons. Some on horses, all carrying weapons.

Boudica smiles.

AIFE
Massacre them today, mother, that you may act responsibly as befits a great queen later.

BOUDICA
I promise, I won't embarrass you again.

Wolfgar, gallops up beside her with a dozen mounted warriors, leading a riderless HORSE.

WOLFGAR
For you, my Queen. She's a good one, a Celtic mare, a heartbreaker and life-taker, as suits you!

Boudica's impressed.

BOUDICA
What a magnificent lady! But what about my daughters, how will they travel.

Wolfgar looks at her, he doesn't break character.

WOLFGAR
The Trinovante Nurse will keep them safe and sound my Queen. They'll be waiting for you after victory.

Boudica looks at the girls.

BOUDICA
Does that suit you, my dears?

They nod and smile, as she mounts up.

The Trinovante Nurse, arrives and stands with the girls as Boudica gallops ahead with Wolfgar.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Glad you came to your senses.

WOLFGAR
My Queen, what is said about you cannot be more true...

BOUDICA
What was that?

WOLFGAR
You will never just be Boudica.

Boudica looks at him, he is deadly serious.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Boudica, Empress of the land, sky and moon. Princess of my soul on the great ride to the after-life!

Boudica gallops ahead, Wolfgar kicks his steed to catch up.

Behind them the Briton force numbers in the HUNDREDS.

51 EXT. ROMAN ROAD TO FALLBROOK FOREST - MORNING 51

FOUR LEGIONARIES march, polished-metal face-armor in the shape of a YELLING WARRIOR. Eagle rests of the Republic.

Another FULL SQUAD ahead of the carriage of Catus, and behind more legionaries, on horseback, a full contingent of EIGHTY or so heavily armed Roman Soldiers.

The way these guys march exudes immense self confidence. Left, right, left, their armor swinging and weapons clanking.

The FOUR LEGIONARIES riding sentinel call a halt.

Lowering their lances.

Ahead Boudica stands in the road, no armor, hair wild, she watches the troop HALT.

The Legionaries quickly take a pragmatic defensive position.

LEGIONAIRIE
Step off the road, *Britonculae*.

BOUDICA
Who the fuck are you talking to?

The Legionaire pauses.

LEGIONAIRIE
Step off the road, or be run through.

BOUDICA
I'm a fucking queen, doesn't Rome want to show her deference to such a queen as me.

LEGIONAIRIE
(quietly)
These fucking guys are on edge, woman, get lost of they'll kill you for fucking sport.

BOUDICA
I'm a Queen and I'd like to speak to your Regent, Catus Decianus.

LEGIONAIRIE
You're out of your gourd.

BOUDICA
Send word to him, the queen of the Icini wishes to parlay.

The Legionaries don't move.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
If you don't tell him about me and he finds out he will have you fined and whipped, I fucking guarantee that.

The Legionary turns and jogs back to Catus' carriage.

The cohort of heavily armed Legionaries don't take their eyes off Boudica, weapons raised, glinting in the sun light.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
Take a good look, if you live to have children they'll ask you about me.

Boudica's searched roughly, her tartan cloaks patted down.

Catus is less amused than he once was. He stumbles forwards, his PRAETORIAN GUARD around him, this is a serious deal.

CATUS
Where is this Britonculae Queen that dares halt my cohort.

Catus strides up close to Boudica.

CATUS (CONT'D)
Well, you have my attention, for the brief moments until I draw and quarter you for your English wolves to dine on, what is it you want, she-dog?

Boudica smiles.

BOUDICA
I'm upset, that you don't recognize me, Dear Catus, has time been so unkind to me?

CATUS
You're mad woman, cut her head off and don't stop again for such trivialities.

Catus turns on his heel.

BOUDICA
I'm Queen Boudica of the Iceni and the Trinovante, the Celts, The Saxons of the Northern Britons.
(beat)
I am the wife of King Prasutagus. And it will take a lot more than your blood to cleanse the foulness you inflicted on me and my daughters, Catus Decianus. Turn and look on my face that you remember.

Catus turns slowly.

He walks close to Boudica examining her.

CATUS
Boudica, Nex Regina, the scar on your cheek has healed. My soldiers like to train against live targets. Today I shall grant that privilege.

Boudica looks to the trees seeing her two daughters.

She holds out her hand.

BOUDICA
Now my children.

The Daughters bring her sword.

Catus watches her extend her hand.

TWO HUGE SHADOW FURIES approach from the woods, a GASP from the Roman lines. They move backwards, leaving Catus alone.

The BRONZE SWORD drops into Boudica's hand.

CATUS
What druid witchery is this?

Boudica lunges forward, pushing her sword into Catus' stomach then slices sideways. Intestines drop at his feet and he collapses to his knees, gasping.

BOUDICA
Don't go anywhere.

He grabs her wrist, she wrenches free, turning. CUTS OFF a Legionaries arm, then slices down at another CLEAVING HIM.

The ENORMOUS SHADOWY FURIES mesmerize and terrify the Romans.

Boudica's streaked with warm-steaming blood, face and clothing drenched with gore. Stephen King's "Carrie" - blood.

Legionaries back away, leaving her facing the kneeling Catus.

CATUS
Centurion!

CENTURION
My liege.

CATUS
Draw thy sword, and slay me, that men say not of me, A women slew him.

Boudica turns and cuts off his head.

The Roman's have had their moment to regroup and they viciously attack with LATIN COMMANDS.

CENTURION
Javelin!

Boudica's DAUGHTER'S CALL HER, she looks at them, then back at the Legionaries.

Boudica runs into the forest. A DOZEN JAVELIN slice through the air and stick trees.

The Legionaries follow.

52 INT. FOREST - DAY 52

Boudica runs behind her two daughters, SPRINTING!

The Legionaries of Catus follow, gaining on her, smashing through the undergrowth, slicing branches in their way.

The sound of a DOZEN LONG BOWS letting loose their ARROWS.

The Legionaries drops, crumpling stuck full of arrows.

The second line is AMBUSHED from the side, speared from the bushes and sliced, and forced into the undergrowth.

The remaining four Legionaries look lost, realizing the enormity of their error they try to run back to the road.

Instantly cut down by BRITONS led by a murderously efficient TRINOVANTE DANIELA. Dressed in leaves and painted with mud and dirt, the Romans are sliced and dropped where they stand.

A Javelin whistles, arcing, dropping Daniela instantly.

53 EXT. ROMAN ROAD TO FALLBROOK FOREST - CONTINUOUS 53

The silence from the forest is deafening.

The Roman Cohort watches the woods. Daniela dead in the road.

On the opposite side of the road, FORTY BRITONS, in mud and leaves, emerge and SCREAM ATTACK!

They slice cut and spear and then, as quickly as they attacked, they withdraw.

The Legionaries barely turn to face the attacker as they are gone into the dense undergrowth.

Then from Boudica's side, more BRITONS charge and attack, only to fall back into the trees.

ROMAN SOLDIERS lie scattered on both road sides, bleeding down the banks. Three horses lie kicking and bleeding, their guts streaming out.

ONLY TWENTY LEGIONARIES still stand, their weapons at the ready, nowhere to run to.

The sound of ARROWS coming from BOWS.

SIX drop skewered by arrow shafts.

The run and are met by the BRITONS charging from behind.

LAST FOUR LEGIONARIES brace, as heavily armed Britons emerge from BOTH SIDES of the road.

The Romans are swiftly executed.

54 EXT. WOODS AFTERMATH OF BATTLE - CONTINUOUS 54

Swords, spears and armor stolen and looted.

Shouting and noise. Boudica looks up spattered with blood.

Ciarán (the traitor) frog-marched forwards by three Britons.

BRITON SOLDIER
He was hiding in the carriage.

CIARÁN
My queen...

Boudica looks into his soul. Her eyes wild. Ciarán struggles.

Boudica stabs him three times, once in the neck, BLOOD streams, he collapses, gurgling.

She's gasping, crying. He's already dead.

BOUDICA
Traitor, traitor, traitor...

Wolfgar embraces her from behind, pulling her away. She struggles. He whispers to her. Calming words.

WOLFGAR
(whisper)
It's over, my Queen. We've won the day, set the die, and started what only you could begin.

He releases her, looking over the utter destruction. The Roman carriage is dismantled, bodies dragged off the road.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
British carrion will gorge, wolves will dine tonight. Their robes will warm our babes tonight, their weapons distributed amongst our army.
(beat)
In an hour their blood will be soaked into the British soil as the stain of Roman occupation soon will be.
(beat)
Congratulations. Most first campaigns are not so successful.

He watches Boudica expecting an answer.

The rage in her subsiding. Boudica drops to her knees, completely streaked with blood, mud and entrails. Her forehead touches the ground gently.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
...My Queen?

BOUDICA
(whisper)
Camulos.

She turns to look up at him.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
We ride for Camulos.

WOLFGAR
Governor Gaius Suetonius Paulinus is away waging war on the Druids in Anglesey. The timing is perfect.
(beat)
We'll need the blessing of the druid council.

BOUDICA
You'll see to it.

Wolfgar smiles, then laughs loudly.

WOLFGAR
You're serious, and I suspect a little mental, my Queen. But war favors the possessed.

He climbs onto his horse.

BOUDICA
Where are you going?

WOLFGAR
I reckon I'm going to the Druid Council to try to find reason for a Celtic Trinovante invasion of occupied Camulos.

BOUDICA
You are indeed.

Boudica smiles. Looks at her DAUGHTERS who smile back.

Boudica helps her daughters up into the saddle with her. One behind, one in front, she gallops away.

55 INT. DRUID COUNCIL UNDERGROUND HALL - NIGHT 55

Sparks and orange flames burst from the huge central fireplace. The DRUIDS hum, eyes closed.

A HUMAN SKULL is placed on a tray.

WOLFGAR
Catus Decianus, you must drink from his skull, then victory is complete.

Boudica looks at the freshly skinned skull. She slowly drinks from it. Wiping her mouth. Wolfgar takes the skull and drinks what Boudica has left.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
I've always said mead tastes best from a Roman skull.

Boudica sits with Wolfgar and her council, there are twenty or so DRUIDS watching her closely.

Boudica looks around anxiously.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
(whisper)
What's the matter?

BOUDICA
(whisper)
Why don't my daughters join me here?

WOLFGAR
They're fine, as ever, my Queen.

DRUID
Queen of the Trinovante and Empress of the Iceni, ruler of the Brigantes of the North and of the Celts. Regent of the Setani and Lopocares, and Chieftain of the Corionototae and the Tectoverdi. Your daughters will not join you here, Boudica.
(beat)
They are like snowflakes, so beautiful to watch, but snatch one from the air, when you open your hand it will be gone!
(beat)
Man is always trying to guess his destiny.
(MORE)

DRUID (CONT'D)
But, there is no destiny but death. It chooses the how and where, the living must just work around what death decides. Ours is the “way” of the Earth and stars, it is the sea and moon that we bow and look towards. It is the way of your people, your ancestors.
(beat)
A “way” that the Roman Legions of Nero would seek to destroy.

BOUDICA
We have the same enemy.

DRUID
There has of late been a succession of ill omens for the Roman occupation Force. The Emperor cult holds stock in the power of omens.

DRUID #2
The great statue of Claudius in Camulos fell, shattering in the street.

DRUID #3
Screams were heard from the church of Augustus for three nights.

DRUID #2
In Gaul Roman bodies washed up on the beach. These are the worst of omens, the very darkest of signs. If you are a Roman.

DRUID
As much as they predict misfortune for Nero they promise fortune for Britannia.
(beat)
The Druid council sanctions your ride to Camulos. May the moon bless you Boudica, and the Briton army that you have united as one.

Burning a POWDER that turns blue exploding into SPARKS.

Wolfgar smiles, patting Boudica on the knee.

WOLFGAR
(whisper)
I’ve never seen this before.
(MORE)

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
With the Druid council behind you there’s nothing you cannot achieve.

BOUDICA
Us, behind us, there is nothing we cannot achieve.

Boudica looks at Wolfgar, who watches the fiery display.

WOLFGAR
You’re staring at me?

BOUDICA
You have your hand on my knee.

Wolfgar removes it swiftly.

WOLFGAR
(whisper)
Twenty years of killing soldiers and chasing their women, forgive me, Queen.

BOUDICA
(whisper)
You’re forgiven, but if you ever touch me like that again I’ll spill your guts before your little man has had a chance to raise himself

WOLFGAR
By God, woman, if I didn’t already have three wives.

BOUDICA
Still no, brave Wolfgar.

WOLFGAR
No one would judge, two warriors, a man and a woman, bonded by blood, by fire by the sword.

BOUIDICA
I am the wife of Prasutagus.

Wolfgar and Boudica look deep into each others eyes.

Boudica stands and leaves.

WOLFGAR
You men see the future, do I, you know, do I get a leg over her?

The Two Principal Druids look horrified.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Bollocks, a man can try can't he?

Wolfgar leaves.

56 EXT. BURIED PIT - DAY 56

Wolfgar sits with his FOREIGN WARRIORS, weapons at the ready.

WOLFGAR
How long has she been sweating?

WARRIOR
Almost two days.

WOLFGAR
She'll be hungry when she comes out.
(beat)
Twenty years of pillaging, looting and mercenary work and no Druid ever blessed me.

WARRIOR
That's why you had such bad luck?

WOLFGAR
Fuck off, eh, I paid you didn't I?

WARRIOR
When I threatened to kill you.

WOLFGAR
We made a lot of money, without a Druid Blessing, imagine how this little raid is going to go?

WARRIOR
That's why we're here. That's why half of Briton is here, and more arrive every day.

WOLFGAR
That tasty whore called Camulos is about to spread her legs for our new Queen. There's more than enough Roman gold for all of us.

WARRIOR
The Romans have homes that are heated from underground fires in the winter, you can walk around half naked while it snows outside.

WOLFGAR
No shit? This will be a good raid.

WARRIOR
The Romans don't care about our forest gods. When we have punished them enough they will send real soldiers, who fight with machines. They'll massacre this rabble. I hope you're smart enough to get us out before then.

This resonates with Wolfgar.

57 INT. UNDERGROUND TEMPLE - DAY 57

It's dark and filled with smoke.

The DRUIDS chant, burning herbs.

Boudica's sweating, naked except for her golden touc she kneels ahead of the fire which reflects on her.

Her back is scarred to HELL from the whipping, her face's scarred from the brand.

Druid#2 puts more herbs into the fire.

58 EXT. FIELD BOUDICA'S MEMORY - DAY 58

Boudica is with her daughters and Prasutagus, the two hounds, laughing, holding hands, playing, they embrace, laughing.

59 INT. UNDERGROUND TEMPLE - DAY 59

SILENCE.

Boudica opens her eyes.

She's not sweating anymore.

She wears the linen robes of a druid.

Ahead of her sits a VERY old man, the GREEN DRUID. The one Prasutagus spoke to.

BOUDICA
You?

GREEN DRUID
You've come far, Queen Boudica, leader of this islands' first massed revolt against Rome.

BOUDICA
So familiar, but I don't know you.

GREEN DRUID
I was private council to the late king.

BOUDICA
He had no private council I knew of.

GREEN DRUID
Never the less I was council to him, his father, and his father's father. I'm older than the world you know and I have seen it's secrets.

BOUDICA
You're nuts.

GREEN DRUID
I'm the Green Druid. I'm an old fart, but, a useful friend.

BOUDICA
You saw my husband before he was murdered, was that useful to him? Why is he not alive?

GREEN DRUID
I warned him that whoever went with Ciarán would be murdered. But that whomever stayed would lead a great revolt against the Romans.

BOUDICA
Why didn't he stay?

GREEN DRUID
Your King knew that if he would be crushed and crucified after his first battle, and his army beheaded in the Roman way.
But, if YOU, Boudica, led the army, it would bond together a nation as one, that had never stood as one.
(beat)
(MORE)

GREEN DRUID (CONT'D)

That you would send a message that would resonate through the millennia and on into legend.

60 INT. PRASUTAGUS HOUSE - MAIN AREA 60

Flashback:

Prasutagus looks over his shoulder at Boudica, his concerned look becomes a smile of infinite sadness.

He turns back to face the Green Druid.

61 INT. BOUDICA'S TENT BRITON LINES 61

BOUDICA
He died for me?

GREEN DRUID
Knew he would die and his daughters and eventually you too. Life is impermanent, transitory.

BOUDICA
What have my daughters to do with this?

GREEN DRUID
Look for their reflection in the lake, they are there, but not there. The breeze as the sun sets. The goose bumps that arrive with the crisp breath of winter. They will always be with you, Boudica.

BOUDICA
I want to die.

GREEN DRUID
You will, but first you must lead your army again.

The Green Druid stands.

BOUDICA
What if I refuse.

GREEN DRUID
You’re free to do as you wish. There is no order in this world, except which death has put there.

She collapses against a wood pillar.

The sound of KETTLE DRUMS.

The Green Druid disappears into the steam.

62 EXT. UNDERGROUND TEMPLE - DAY 62

Boudica emerges exhausted.

The kettle drums are noisy. A raucous band plays stolen Roman drums and horns.

Wolfgar does a double take and rushes to her side.

WOLFGAR
You need to rest.

BOUDICA
What is that awful noise.

WOLFGAR
They are musicians, they've come to march with us. A Queen needs a retinue.

BOUDICA
We can feed only warriors my vanity doesn't require an orchestra.

WOLFGAR
You lead, we'll fight, I'll feed the musicians. They're good for the men.

BOUDICA
My daughters, have you been watching them.

WOLFGAR
Like a hawk. They're well behaved girls.

BOUDICA
Yes, yes they are.

WOLFGAR
Get her food ready. We have clothing and supplies ready for you.

BOUDICA
How long was I in there?

WOLFGAR
Almost a week, six days, you must be famished.

Boudica looks at his arm around her.

BOUDICA
I told you not to touch me, fucker!

WOLFGAR
If I release you you'll drop face first into the mud, not a good look for a warrior Queen.

BOUDICA
Then keep a hold of me and stop complaining, you lump!

Wolfgar keeps his Queen standing.

63 EXT. FIELDS AND DOWNS - DAY 63

A sharp wind blows.

TWO FARMERS watch silently, huddled in skins, holding pitch forks. One scratches his head.

The MASSED BRITON army marches down a Roman road. There are hundreds of "wannabe soldiers," weekend warriors, and dangerous looking thugs. Some by foot, some on horseback.

At their head rides BOUDICA, Wolfgar beside her. Wolfgar's mercenaries around them as praetorian guard.

One of the Farmers calls out.

FARMER
Where you goin?

MERCENARY
To Camulos to kill Romans and steal their gold.

FARMER
Can anyone join?

MERCENARY
Yes.

FARMER
I'm going to get me some of that.

FARMER #2
Your mother’s going to kill you!

The Farmer joins in with the hoard.

WARRIOR
This is a rabble it’s no army.

WOLFGAR
Not yet it isn’t, give it time.

64 EXT. HILL OVERLOOKING CAMULOS - SUNRISE 64

THE CITY OF CAMULOS - spread out in a valley - all is quiet. Several farmers walk with cows and a dog barks somewhere. Roosters hail the suns’ first light.

Boudica walks to the top of the hill overlooking the City, the sun rising behind her, a light wind brushes her hair across her face.

Wolfgar joins her, dressed for war.

For a beat it’s just the two of them.

Then the rumble of massed leather armor and weapons.

An extended line of FIVE HUNDRED or more Britons, crests the hill, silhouetted like the Maasai over Rourke's Drift. Their faces tense, quietly looking down on the Roman settlement.

WOLFGAR
Want to forgive and forget. We go home and live another day.

Wolfgar grins.

BOUDICA
Fuck them!

WOLFGAR
That’s my Queen.

Wolfgar makes a call that is whispered throughout the force.

65 EXT. CAMULOS GUARD HOUSE - MORNING 65

FIVE OF ROMAN SOLDIERS, UNDER THE COMMAND OF A CENTURION stands picket beside a spiked wooden battlement.

The GRASS appears to move around them and a dozen BRITONS emerge, camouflaged.

They swiftly execute the Five Romans, The Centurion's HEAD is wedged onto one of the spiked gate posts. The Gates are opened.

66 EXT. HILL OVERLOOKING CAMULOS - SUNRISE 66

Wolfgar issues a silent command and the entire army moves down the hill towards the City.

Boudica appears in slow-motion, she nods and grins, hair fluttering in the breeze.

Her daughters appear beside her, taking her hands in theirs.

BOUDICA
My babies. Do you come to stop me?

AIFE
We come to support you, dearest Mother.

BRE
Lay waste to them all, mother, raise Camulos to the ground and burn it's people.

BOUDICA
This we shall do.

Each daughter slowly releases Boudica's hands, drifting back into the darkness. Boudica is alone again.

Boudica watches over her army, she draws her BRONZE SWORD. It hums in her hand. Wolfgar smiles, draws his sword.

Boudica YELLS - the first time we have seen this primal act, teeth bared she commands her army with a BANSHEE WAIL!

The army starts to run, then to sprint, then shouting.

Wolfgar is running, the noise of human movement is deafening.

THE MUSICIANS POUND the kettle drums as the horns start-up.

67 EXT. CAMULOS - DAY 67

500 or more Britons surge into the streets. Blades and spears flashing in the sun.

A retinue of TWENTY barely woken ROMANS SOLDIERS rushes out, they are cut down very quickly. Limbs severed, heads removed.

Armor and weapons stolen. Their barracks are set fire.

The Britons howl and scream with an animalistic blood lust.

ROMAN FAMILIES run to the temple, children, men, women.

The BRITONS destroy everything in their path.

Boudica slices through two Romans, spattered with blood. One tries to grab her, she kicks him away.

A MOUNTED ROMAN with lance, charges Boudica. She turns to the horses blind side and takes out it's legs, sending it sliding into the dirt. The rider, gathers his senses drawing his short sword.

Boudica is on him, and takes off his head with one blow.

68 INT. ROMAN HOME - CONTINUOUS 68

A crowd of Britons smashes in the side of a ROMAN HOME. They kill the father and mother instantly.

A PREADOLESCENT CHILD is taken by it's ankle and struck against the wall, by a Briton.

Oil Lamps are smashed and flames streak up the walls and across the floor.

69 EXT. CAMULOS - CONTINUOUS 69

The Temple doors are slammed closed and barricaded inside.

Boudica looks at the enormous expensive temple.

BOUDICA
Barricade the doors from the outside. Open the roof, pour fire down on them.

Wolfgar looks at her.

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
What we do, we do to send a message to Rome.

70 EXT. CAMULOS TEMPLE ROOF - CONTINUOUS 70

Tiles are shattered, below HUNDREDS OF ROMAN CIVILIANS scream.

Britons carry cauldrons of tar/bitumen, which is ignited and poured down through the roof. Results as imagined.

71 EXT. CAMULOS STREETS - CONTINUOUS 71

Three ROMAN SOLDIERS attempts to fight, but the Briton numbers are overwhelming, it's like attempting to contain a riot. They're engulfed and stabbed, limbs are torn off.

A Roman head is crushed flat under foot, spattering brains.

Another has his body torn into two pieces by the throng.

A Roman is lanced and skewered to a wall, as he's pounded by multiple weapons, his skull shattered explicitly.

It's a messy, ultra violent cleansing. No Roman spared.

72 EXT. CAMULOS STREETS - EVENING 72

The Temple burns with the city around it in the distance.

The Briton's tow carts filled to the brim with the spoils of war. Statues, grain, food, urns of wine, farm animals.

Boudica watches the city burn, the flames reflected on her face. Hair wild, face spattered with blood and dirt.

WOLFGAR
Beautiful retribution.

BOUDICA
It's not enough. Not nearly.

Boudica rides away. Wolfgar watches.

73 INT/EXT. BOUDICA'S CAMP - NIGHT 73

A fire burns for light, and candles.

Cartimanda watches her, she's also beaten up and exhausted.

A large copper bath steams with water.

Boudica's streaked with the blood and gore of battle.

She's exhausted, her hair stands up thick with dirt.

Her two daughters watch Cartimanda remove their mother's torn and slashed clothing. Leaving just the golden touc.

Boudica washes her face, puts her face beneath the water. She washes her face, touching the scar on her cheek.

We see blood clouding in the washing water. Cartimanda cleans her with a sheep's hide. Her arms, hands and shoulders.

AIFE
They will send cavalry to destroy you.

BOUDICA
I will kill whoever they send and then find where they live and kill their families.

BRE
You must do it, mother. For us, for father.

BOUDICA
The Druid elder said I had more battles to fight.

The daughters look at each other.

AIFE
Yes, then we will be together.

BRE
Your work will be done here.

Boudica wraps a blanket around herself watches her daughters.

There is a strange screaming outside, massed yelling and groaning, Boudica leaves the tent.

74 EXT. BOUDICA'S TENT BRITON LINES - CONTINUOUS 74

Wolfgar is sentinel outside Boudica's tent. He's threading a ROMAN FLAG to a LANCE with thin-gut thread.

Boudica emerges from the tent, Wolfgar looks up at her.

GROANING AND YELLING can be heard from the camp.

BOUDICA
Why aren't they celebrating?

WOLFGAR
They're paying tribute for the victory.

BOUDICA
To whom?

Wolfgar yells. TWO WARRIORS approach, freshly scarred cheeks.

WOLFGAR
By cutting your mark into their cheek. They pay tribute to you, my Queen.
(beat)
Roman soldiers have their stigma, now your men have theirs.

BOUDICA
Do they know what it means?

WOLFGAR
Who gives a shit, they don't read Latin. What matters is that it's your mark. They're your army now.

The two warriors nod respectfully at Boudica, leaving.

BOUDICA
What are you doing?

WOLFGAR
The Roman's take great pride in their unit formations, my men take great pleasure in relieving the silks from the defeated. These are the units you have crushed.

He levels the lance and we see THREE ROMAN SILKS attached.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
The spoils of war, my Queen.

He jams the lance into the ground.

75 TIME ELAPSE SEQUENCE - DAY/NIGHT 75

The LANCE remains centered, but the background changes, woods, mountains, valleys - Rain, snow, sun.

The THREE unit-silks becomes a dozen then twenty, as the background changes and the seasons shift.

76 EXT. CAMP - NIGHT 76

Men sit around a fire sending glowing embers into the night.

VOLUNTEER
So can I look forward to losing my fucking eye, like you?

Wolgar smiles, his beard thicker, a vicious SCAR now channels his cheek from a healed wound that gouged out his eye.

WOLFGAR
Well, I've been in the thick of it for the whole run. So, I saw a little more than the average soldier, being at the front.

VOLUNTEER
Fighting Romans! You're fucking mad as a March hare.

WOLFGAR
Being at the front has it's perks, lads.

VOLUNTEER
'Like my face the way it is, thank you, governor.

WOLFGAR
See that old curricle, the one with the wolfskin cover?

VOLUNTEER
Aye.

WOLFGAR
There's five armed Beserkers standing sentinel beside it, none of those five will sleep tonight and tomorrow, they'll be replaced by five more.
(beat)
Because my young friend, hidden inside it is a treasure hoard to make a King blush. Gold, Silver, Ivory from Africa, Jewels and valuables from the Nile, Statues and women's adornments and engraved trinkets carved in such finery you'd think you were dreaming to behold.

VOLUNTEER
You don't say.

WOLFGAR
Aye. It pays to be at the front. But to be honest, there was such hordes of treasures, my own mule handlers and serfs. Who were never close to the fighting, were filling their pockets with Roman gold.

VOLUNTEER
You think we could get rich, like your men. Not as rich as you, I wager, but like your men, a man like me?

VOLUNTEER #2
I wouldn't know what to do with, it would be a liability.

VOLUNTEER
I'd learn quickly. You wouldn't see me lose it in a game of dice.

Wolfgar leans in, TEN VOLUNTEERS gather around the fire listening.

WOLFGAR
Well, after we burned and looted Camulos, we was in the hot spot. The Romans knew about us and knew what we meant. How Boudica was bringing this great British army together as a one that had never been one before. They got scared and there's nothing worse than a scared Roman.

Wolfgar narrates the next two battles and wins to the fascinated Volunteers.

77 EXT. WOODS - DAY 77

Wolfgar's story:

WOLFGAR
(os)
They sends in the Ninth Legion Hispana. A Calvary unit that had distinguished itself for it's bravery and ruthlessness in Spain, under the Command of the great Roman General Quintus Petillius Cerialis.

QUINTUS PETILLIUS CERIALIS rides ahead of a MAGNIFICENT COLUMN OF ROMAN HORSEMEN.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
(os)
But where the great and brave general Petillius knew warfare in the field, he didn't know the thick woods of our lovely sweet country. We ambushed him in Cambridge forest and Boudica's generals fought like British wolves. And gentlemen, that mighty cavalry unit that had done so well on the plains of Spain was devastated, viciously and ruthlessly. Because an Englishman with his heat up is a formidable foe.

We see Britons ambush Romans, slaying them mercilessly.

Boudica rides amongst them, fighting from horseback.

Cartimanda in her blue warpaint, sword glinting, killing and laughing with her tribe.

Wolfgar launching into the Romans, is struck in the face, losing his eye in the mess.

Boudica gallops to his side, protecting him. He looks up at her with one good eye. Her HORSE IS KNOCKED DOWN, by a Roman lance. She fights on foot, back to back with Wolfgar.

The fight will be won, but this moment is vicious and bloody. The result could go either way.

78 EXT. CAMP - NIGHT 78

The Volunteer interrupts the story.

VOLUNTEER
English Woman, Boudica's a woman, no, her sword bearer, too?

WOLFGAR
You're quite the lad aren't you?

VOLUNTEER
A cavalry unit couldn't have been carrying much treasure?

79 EXT. WOODS - DAY 79

Petilius attempts to withdraw his forces, commanding the retreat, HORNS ARE BLOWN. His personal Phalanx around him, he's surrounded by angry Britons.

His horse rears, Petilius is thrown from the saddle.

Brought down by a Briton lance, his Phalanx destroyed.

Wolfgar watches from amongst a throng of screaming warriors, he raises an AXE.

Petilius crashes to the ground on his back, winded, helmet thrown clear, he's gasping for air.

AN AXE COMES DOWN ON HIS NECK. His head severed. Wolfgar reaches down, lifts the head, jamming it onto a spear-tip, he replaces Petilius's helmet adjusting it.

After the battle:

ROMAN SOLDIER'S HEADS hung from saddles, and on spear tips.

The Roman Cavalry UNIT SILKS are sliced from their stations.

Boudica watches Wolfgar and his men divide the ROMAN GOLD. They're like Bonnie and Clyde, there is something here. There is a sparkle in Boudica's eye we haven't seen before.

Boudica sees her daughters both staring at her, wordlessly the sparkle vanishes.

80 EXT. WOODS - NIGHT 80

An urn of wine, bearing the Roman mark, is opened and poured.

The Briton army eats and drinks and Boudica actually laughs, now she smiles at Wolfgar, who smiles back.

Boudica leaves with Cartimanda.

Wolfgar watches them leave, he's falling for Boudica.

81 EXT. CAMP - NIGHT 81

Momentarily wistful, Wolfgar gets back on track.

WOLFGAR
...Perhaps not. But there was gold denarii for the unit payroll, and a year's salary for the Roman forts from there to the land of the Picts. Gold is heavy lads. It has a special weight to it, value, a weight man will kill for, lust for, love for!

Wolfgar reveals a narrow GOLD INGOT marked SPQR to show the volunteers. He grins at their expressions.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
The Roman marking, SPQR, Senatus Populusque Romanus.

VOLUNTEER
What is this of the ghosts of her daughters?

WOLFGAR
It's nothing, nothing at all for you to worry about.
(beat)
If you are a Briton. If you're a Roman, well then it's another matter altogether.

82 EXT. COUNTRY OUTSIDE LONDON - MORNING 82

Early morning. The combined armies of Boudica and Wolfgar are spread over a huge grass valley. Marching, weapons in hand, fixed expressions, burning torches.

Cartimanda like her tribe is painted blue, joins the march.

WOLFGAR
(os)
After Cambridge, our Queen made the audacious decision to march on Londinium, London to you lads. The great trade center on the Thames, home to the richest Roman merchants, importers, slave traders, gold testers, conveyors of spice, salt, and dyes from the orient and jewel makers filled by the coffers of the great Emperors of Africa to the Northern most reaches of man.

Boudica's army charges down cobbled London streets, cutting down Roman soldiers, livestock and civilians.

Roman civilians attempt to evacuate London by boat. They're struck down and cut off by smaller Briton craft, grappling hooks and hooked pole arms.

Murdered, blood streams into the river water and their vessels set on fire.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
(os)
It was a flaming, burning, carnage, but, lads, hear me out when I say there was so much gold it would make you blind like in the snow on a sunny day.

Explicitly violent scenes of murderous destruction and pillaging, burning, stabbing, cutting, wholesale slaughter.

Cartimanda and her men fight like maniacs, yelling, vaulting and lunging into the Roman defenses. The blue skin streaked with blood and soot.

BOUDICA SLASHES AND CUTS FROM A CHARIOT for the first time. Galloping through the streets slashing and cutting.

Wolfgar gallops beside her, with his troop, it's a slaughter more than a battle.

Boudica's obsessed, crazed, wolf-eyed as she gallops.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
(os)
You ask about the ghosts of her daughters. Well, if you saw her commanding that chariot, her hair wild, and teeth bared. Bronze blade glistening in the firelight of that doomed city. You'd swear too that you witnessed great pitch-dark clouds moving, like flame-winged furies behind her. A dreadful image my lads, like something drawn from deep in the shadow realm, dark as Indian ink and seeping with vengeance and blood lust. They make her invincible and ruthless, like nothing Holy of this Earth.

Boudica gallops, the chariot wheels crashing down the cobbled street. Three Roman soldiers are systematically obliterated in violent clouds of red spatter and limbs.

Wolfgar watches, GREAT DARK CLOUDS BEHIND HER, LIGHTNING and thunder inside them. They take on the shape of TWO WINGED WOMEN WARRIORS. Giants flexing behind Boudica.

Wolfgar and Boudica fight back to back again.

A SHADOW appears to cover the Romans and warriors fighting around her, until it is ONLY Boudica and Wolfgar fighting in silence.

Roman soldiers and Britons pause, it's unearthly for sure...

...Boudica, Wolfgar behind her, swinging her sword in SLOW MOTION, cutting viciously at Romans, her face determined.

We pull back and see the City of London burning ferociously, and barbarians fighting Romans huge numbers of fighters.

83 EXT. LONDON - EVENING 83

LATER.

The sun sets.

Boudica and Wolfgar lead their GREAT ARMY away from the burning city of London. CARTS AND CARTS AND CARTS loaded with treasures, roman statues and gold chairs.

Laughing, joking Briton warriors, all covered in blood and soot, drunk on the adrenaline-dump or Roman wine.

SLAVES, LIVESTOCK AND WOMEN tied and on chains.

84 EXT. CAMP - NIGHT 84

VOLUNTEER
Is there any left worth stealing, sounds like you lot got it all?

Wolfgar smiles, sipping a cup of wine.

WOLFGAR
The Palace of Noviomagus Reginorum.

VOLUNTEER
That's in the land of the Atrebates.

WOLFGAR
Yes, and we'll kill, enslave or turn all of those Roman ass kissers, too.
(MORE)

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
The richest and most profitable city yet, my lads.
(beat)
It’s the same size as Nero's Golden House in Rome and richer than the Villa Romana del Casale near to Piazza Armerina in Sicily. You can only imagine the treasures held there within, lads.
(beat)
So, are you in? Do you join us?

Wolfgar watches them, they yell their approval.

WOLFGAR (CONT’D)
Draw weapons. If you don’t have them, we have plenty. Go get some food we have a long way to travel tomorrow.

The Volunteers cheer and laugh, grabbing WEAPONS. They’re excited thinking about the treasures to come, and the weight of the Roman weapons in their hands.

Wolfgar stands stretching his back and wanders away.

85 EXT. CAMP WOLFGAR CARTS - NIGHT CONTINUOUS 85

Wolfgar leans on the wolfskin cart. His five men watch him.

WARRIOR
Have you said your goodbyes?

WOLFGAR
It’s not so easy a thing.

WARRIOR
We have more than what was agreed, it’s time to go home, to our families. We have nothing to gain from further war.

WOLFGAR
You men go ahead, I’ll stay.

WARRIOR
You’re our leader, your own wife and family wait for you, Wolfgar. This is not our war, she murders Romans for a reason beyond gold, not our reason.

WOLFGAR
I pledged myself to her.

WARRIOR
A chieftain cannot pledge himself to two houses.

WOLFGAR
Let me bid farewell to her.

The Warriors watch him.

86 EXT. BOUDICA'S CAMP - NIGHT 86

Wolfgar alone, talks to himself, amongst the cart horses.

WOLFGAR
My Queen, we have been successful, we have ridden side by side in battle and celebrated great victories. But now the time is come for me to bid thee farewell. Fuck! I've ridden in battle with you Queen, and loved you and always will love you, but my men are tired, and miss their families. Their bags are packed full with gold and their spirits are elsewhere. God Shit, not blaming my men. Boudica, we've ridden for Briton, for you, and now it's time for my them to return to their homes, and tend business. We will return in the Spring. Renewed and...

A noise ahead of Wolfgar distracts him, he lunges with a flaming torch.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Who's there?

Cartimanda glares at him in the firelight.

Her eyes bursting with venom and hatred. She runs.

WOLFGAR (CONT'D)
Fuck.

87 INT. BOUDICA'S TENT BRITON LINES - NIGHT 87

Boudica looks up.

BOUDICA
What should my men think of you leaving?

WOLFGAR
Tell them the truth, that I'll return in the Spring with more men from the North to bolster your ranks.

BOUDICA
I'd be lying.

WOLFGAR
I am with wife, several wives, my Queen. My children who have not seen their father in months. My men have earned their gold with blood, now the time has come to enjoy it.

BOUDICA
You could become stronger than any Briton King before you. I have no interest in crown, or gold, you can take my share.
(beat)
I cannot lose. You know that, why not push the Romans out. Finish the job we started?

WOLFGAR
My men will fight in any weather, the winter battlefield doesn't scare them. But where do they sleep, what do they eat? I don't ask my men fight in the winter and your men should not either.

AIFE
He's scared, you can hear the fear in his voice.

Boudica looks at her daughters, Wolfgar sees this.

BRE
He loves you, mother. You have rejected him, so he leaves.

AIFE
Lay down with him, he'll stay.

BRE
He would be king, you could be queen. Together you will defy fate and destroy Rome's armies.

WOLFGAR
What do your daughters say?

BOUDICA
It is our swiftness that has destroyed the Romans. Move decisively and we end this occupation.

WOLFGAR
Have you looked at your army?

BOUDICA
The largest army of Britons ever raised.

WOLFGAR
Sprawling, untrained, aggressive, greedy. fractioned. It's Samhain. Give a speech, tell them to enjoy their spoils and return in the Spring, the *earrach*, for more looting. When they're fresh and rested.
(beat)
The men that turn out for you will be the greatest fighting force ever, and you'll smash the Romans resolutely.

BOUDICA
Or we smash them now, while we have momentum.

Wolfgar knew this would be the outcome.

He nods and standing.

WOLFGAR
No doubt, but it will be without me.

BOUDICA
I can order you to stay, or have you killed.

WOLFGAR
You could, but you won't.

Wolfgar nods and leaves the tent.

AIFE/BRE
Why mother?

BOUDICA
I can love only one man.

The sound of a snivel.

Boudica turns, Cartimanda is sobbing.

She locks eyes with Boudica and leaves following Wolfgar.

BRE
Perhaps it's best that you move swiftly, mother. It may become a problem when these warriors discover their love for you is one sided.

BOUDICA
Who do they send against me?

BRE
As we speak the great General Gaius Paulinus marches on Watling street to meet you. His men adore him, and he loves them back.

BOUDICA
We will surprise them.

Boudica listens, standing, she leaves the tent.

88 EXT. CAMP - NIGHT 88

Wolfgar is loading a mule, that is weighted down with treasure, it is at the head of SIX MULE CARTS of treasure, his soldiers stand guard uneasily.

Wolfgar notices Boudica is watching him silently.

He wipes his hair out of his face and meets Boudica's glance.

BOUDICA
I cast no judgement.

WOLFGAR
Ask me to stay.

BOUDICA
We will see each other again in the *Earrach*, when the snow has melted.

Wolfgar weighs her words.

WOLFGAR
Boudica...

BOUDICA
Yes?

Wolfgar can't bring himself to say anything.

He mounts his horse, yells a command, repeated by his men.

Boudica watches him leave.

Wolfgar pauses a distance away, turning back.

WOLFGAR
You will always be the princess of my soul on the great ride to the after-life, Boudica. Empress of the land, sky and moon!

He holds his sword aloft and crests the hill, gone.

Boudica watches him then turns as the DRUIDS pass her, also leaving the camp.

The Green Druid looks back at her and nods, and is gone.

Boudica exhales.

89 INT. BOUDICCA'S TENT BRITON LINES - MORNING 89

Dust hangs in golden fingers of sun light in the tent.

Boudica's hair is braided with golden thread. A polished gold HEAD BAND is pressed flat against her brow.

A GIANT GOLDEN TOUC, a Kilo of solid Celtic gold is twisted and wrapped around her neck.

Her arms and fingers laden with bands and rings of gold.

Boudica inspects the polished BRONZE SWORD, weighing it in her hand, it hums, VIBRATING QUIETLY, not like before.

The sword's "glow" appears to dull in her hand.

90 EXT. ROMAN LINES - MORNING 90

Giant bonfires burn, Roman Soldiers drop FRESHLY CUT GREEN BRANCHES on the fires. Creating a DENSE FOG, which hangs in the morning air like an old London Pea-souper.

Gaius Suetonius Paulinus watches the fog, his TEN MAN armed Phalanx around him, FOUR HUGE GERMAN SHEPHERD DOGS on leashes. A Roman Noble nearby, TACITUS (70 years.)

TACITUS
If she is victorious, Dear Suetonius she will not make prisoners of your men, and reserve them for slavery. That is not the idea of a people who despise all the laws of war. The halter and the gibbet, slaughter and defoliation, fire and sword, will be the marks of their savage valor.

PAULINUS
They're not soldiers who come to offer battle; they're amateurs, and I, my learned friend, am a professional.

91 EXT. BRITISH LINES - DAY 91

The HEAVY FOG is dense around the Boudica's SPRAWLING ARMY.

Boudica ushers her CHARIOT forwards. Cartimanda, the Trinovante bodyguard, follows in her own chariot behind.

Her horses wear the iron age Celtic armor of the time.

Foot SOLDIERS AND CAVALRY watch. The British front line, bare chested, skin dyed with Woad, weapons of all descriptions.

Their cheeks branded and hair spiked with lime, into the "mane" of *Epona*. The watch their leader, Queen and figurehead, slowly ride their lines, inspecting them, she draws to a halt ahead of the Briton lines.

She dismounts kneeling ahead of her battle horses, she kisses the grass, standing to face her soldiers.

BOUDICA
I do not come to boast of a great ancestry, nor to recover my kingdom and plundered wealth of my family.
(MORE)

BOUDICA (CONT'D)
I'm here to assert the cause of liberty and to seek revenge for my body seamed with scars, revenge for my two daughters, my King and my home.
(beat)
From the pride and arrogance of the Romans nothing is sacred; But the vindictive gods are now at hand. The Romans will pay with their lives for their rashness.
(beat)
Look around, see your brothers, and sisters and view our numbers. Behold how our tribes come together to draw the avenging sword.
(beat)
On this spot we must conquer, or die with glory. There is no alternative.

Boudica thrusts her sword into the air, it hums and glows.

There is a MIGHTY ROAR from the British lines. They break into a modern *Soccer Hooligan chorus*.

BRITON LINES
(football hooligan chant)
Come on you Celts, fuck the Romans!
Come on you Celts, fuck the Romans!
Come on you Celts, fuck the Romans!

Looking over the lines, they are amped up!

Drunken frenzy of weapons, vomiting, severed ROMAN HEADS hanging from belts and aloft on spear tips. Beards and blades. These are English Hooligans, missing teeth, eyes, overweight, ugly. WAR-DOGS on leashes bark and growl.

TEN CARNYX HORN PLAYERS MARCH FORWARD. They blast a vicious melody that accompanies the Hooligan chant.

Boudica nods at Cartimanda, who yells an order in Celtic. The whole army starts its march forwards through the fog.

Ahead a SKIRMISH LINE of disciplined Roman Soldiers stands glistening deathly still in the morning mist.

Boudica's army appears from the mist, riding her chariot along her lines. The HOOLIGAN chant is overwhelming. A THUG pisses at the Romans. Horseback and chariots, dogs.

Boudica at the front sees the Roman line.

The hoard see the Roman line, and charge, passing Boudica.

BOUDICA
Wait, we must be disciplined!

Cartimanda gallops CUTTING OFF THE HOARD with several other trinovante, yelling orders, and the rabble pauses.

92 EXT. ROMAN LINES - CONTINUOUS 92

The Romans wait, trembling, eyes wide.

Latin military orders are yelled from the mist.

The Romans retreat ahead of the hoard.

The first wave of Britons chase the romans around a narrow valley, smoke filled and misty.

THE ROMAN LINE FORMS AGAIN behind them, cutting off the charge. Resealing to face the Briton army again.

93 EXT. BRITON LINE - CONTINUOUS 93

We hear the Hooligan chant stop.

Then shouting, screaming, in the mist, then absolute silence.

Followed by more Latin Roman orders.

Boudica watches the Roman line that faces them.

TRINOVANTE WARRIOR
They try to ambush us.

94 EXT. ROMAN LINES REAR - CONTINUOUS 94

Gaius Suetonius Paulinus watches, FLAG BEARERS beside him.

PAULINUS
She is cautious but her army is over confident, we will use that over confidence to divide them. Advance three paces.

A flag order is given, then orders in Latin from the ground.

95 EXT. ROMAN LINES - CONTINUOUS 95

The long line of Romans takes THREE STEPS FORWARDS.

Standing motionless ahead of the Briton force.

Who start yelling insults and Hooligan chanting again.

More Latin orders.

The Roman line slap their shields and advance three more steps, then another three.

96 EXT. BRITON LINE - CONTINUOUS 96

Boudica galloping her chariot watches the Roman line, looks up to the hill where Seutonius commands.

Her Britons scream and yell, uncontrollable.

97 EXT. ROMAN LINES - CONTINUOUS 97

Another huge MASS OF BRITONS charge screaming at the Roman line. Several Romans soldiers are BRAINED and go down, before the line withdraws.

The Britons disappear chasing the Romans into the mist.

Suetonius watches from above as the Britons rush the valley, flag orders, spoken Latin.

98 EXT. BRITON LINE - CONTINUOUS 98

Boudica listens as the yelling becomes silence, again. Now the remains of her army go quiet, no more chanting, as every man and woman listens for the sound of battle.

In her chariot her two daughters sit ready for war.

AIFE
They just killed half of your army, mother.

Boudica watches the Roman line reform.

BRE
They use your army's confidence to ruin it.

Boudica gallops up and down her ranks yelling to Cartimanda the Trinovante.

BOUDICA
(shouting)
We must flank the Roman line and not follow it into the valley!!!!

Cartimanda is confused.

The noise of the Briton army complaining is overwhelming.

Cartimanda gives an order to charge and Boudica is galloping with her army.

Boudica gallops her chariot ahead of the remains of her forces a terrifying spectacle, bearing in on the Roman line.

99 EXT. ROMAN LINES REAR - CONTINUOUS 99

PAULINUS
She must be mad?

100 EXT. ROMAN LINES - CONTINUOUS 100

Boudica smashes through the Roman skirmish line, absolutely destroying it. Limbs are severed, and shiny Roman armor is shattered and left bloody.

The Britons rush through the fog into the Roman kill area.

101 EXT. ROMAN KILL AREA - CONTINUOUS 101

The fog clears on hundreds of dead Britons.

Javelin spikes and arrows stuck into bodies of men, horses and dogs, pools of blood everywhere.

Above them high an armored line of Roman soldiers, yell and drop the shields FORMING A WALL.

Boudica screams orders, reigning in her chariot. British arrows hit the Roman wall.

Roman shield wall opens revealing BALLISTA ARROW LAUNCHERS.

They Immediately OPEN FIRE.

Then a line of ROMAN ARCHERS LAUNCH THEIR ARROWS as the Ballistas are reloaded.

Dropping dozens of Britons, skewered on shafts and arrows.

A LATIN ORDER, flags send the signal and a SHIELD TORTOISE PHALANX appears flanking the Britons in the kill area.

The TORTOISE PHALANX advances, cutting anything in its way.

Boudica's horses are hit by BALLISTA BOLTS and her Chariot topples, spilling her out. She rolls, cutting her head, and is covered in dirt and debris.

She's joined in the cover of her upturned vehicle by several soldiers and Cartimanda, who BLEEDS and looks terrified.

Boudica surveys the kill area, her army lies dead in steep ragged piles around her position. Looking down streams of blood weave their way through the stones and dirt.

A GROUP OF BRITONS charge together from their position.

Boudica watches, as the Ballista line, fires another salvo.

The Group of Britons, tumble, as they're skewered instantly.

The SHIELD TORTOISE is ordered forwards. LATIN COMMANDS are yelled over the fighting and the Tortoise advances.

Changing the Britons from wounded to mortally-wounded.

Boudica desperately looks around her position.

CARTIMANDA
Ask your daughters for the banshees. Our Banshees, Boudica!

Boudica listens and looks around for her daughters.

They stand together on a PILE OF BODIES in the killing area.

BOUDICA
Are you going to help us?

AIFE
The time for fighting is over, mother.

BOUDICA
Then what?

AIFE
It is time for you to join us.

Boudica yells "NO!"

CARTIMANDA
What do they say?

BOUDICA
This our time.

Cartimanda looks at her, and nods.

A Ballista bolt, passes through Boudica's chariot slamming into a Briton and sending him sliding away, dead.

Boudica weighs the bronze sword in her hand.

CARTIMANDA
That's it?

BOUDICA
After what we've been through, I don't want to die cowering behind a broken cart.

CARTIMANDA
I go where you go.

BRITON SOLDIER
We leave this cover we'll be massacred!

BOUDICA
On my command we charge their skirmish line.

CARTIMANDA
On your word, my Queen.

BRITON SOLDIER
You're both insane!

Boudica calls on her reserves.

She grips Cartimanda's hand, they look at each other and smile. Nodding, it's time.

BOUDICA
Let's go!

Boudica follows Cartimanda out into the killing field.

They charge the Ballista line.

Roman Soldiers adjust the wheels of the war machines to adjust their aim...

Then Roman Soldiers drop, javelin's stuck in their bodies.

A YELLING Wolfgar and his troops have flanked the Ballista line, slicing and hacking at the Roman soldiers.

Seeing this, Boudica stops running.

She's crying as Wolfgar kills a Roman and waves to her.

Wolfgar's men turn the ballista on the Roman Shield Tortoise, firing, the Tortoise stumbles as a DOZEN soldiers drop.

For a brief moment, chaos ensues, the Britons have the field.

102 EXT. ROMAN LINES REAR - CONTINUOUS 102

Gaius Suetonius Paulinus shouts in Latin and his order is conveyed by semaphore.

PAULINUS
Hispana Triumphalis Legion forwards to the Ballista.

103 EXT. ROMAN KILL AREA - CONTINUOUS 103

The Roman Shield Tortoise backs up to recover.

The Hispana Triumphalis Legion charges from the opposite flank to reinforce the Ballista line.

CARTIMANDA
They must reload to keep firing.

BOUDICA
His men do not understand the Roman machinery.

The Hispana Legion hacks through Wolfgar's men, turning the Ballista away from the Roman lines.

Boudica and Wolfgar look at each other, smiling.

This moment plays as if in slow motion, both of them, swords lowered, vulnerable, facing each other.

Boudica is crying tears.

WOLFGAR
You are the princess of my soul on the great ride to the after-life, Boudica. Empress of my land, my sky and my moon!

He blows her a kiss and raises his sword.

A Ballista bolt SLAMS THROUGH HIM pinning him to the Ballista closest to him, he's then hit by a dozen Roman arrows.

Boudica screams, yelling, dropping to her knees.

Cartimanda grabs her pulling her to cover.

104 ROMAN LINES REAR - CONTINUOUS 104

Gaius Suetonius Paulinus is a tactician.

PAULINUS
Wipe them out, use pylon and javelin. Then charge her forces with cavalry, until none breath.

Cartimanda drags a sobbing boudica towards the chariot.

Briton man and beast are slaughtered around them.

The Roman Shield Tortoise is broken up into fighting Romans.

Boudica fights a Roman with her sword, killing him, then another. Cartimanda at her side.

Boudica focuses on the battle.

AIFE
(vo)
You did everything we asked of you and more. Time to be a mother and wife again. To love and to cherish. Today your name in sacrifice is more important than your victory in battle, Boudica.

Boudica and Cartimanda SLASH AND FIGHT. Cartimanda is cut down first. Then Boudica is STRUCK, AND STABBED. As swarths of Roman weaponry advances.

A Latin COMMAND orders the soldiers back.

Boudica is swollen and bleeding. She stands, weakly, knee deep in Briton dead.

Roman archers come forwards, on command. She's hit by TWO DOZEN ARROWS, stumbling.

The remaining British are cut down by the Romans.

Boudica is almost indistinguishable from her brother dead.

105 EXT. FOREST - DAY 105

A FLASHBACK FROM HAPPIER TIMES:

Prasutagus wheels his glistening horses in a sharp circle, grinning form ear to ear. His horse rears and drops, snorting.

PRASUTAGUS
So help me, is it possible that you never age my most wonderful Goddess of the forest? I have always loved you and always will, sweet Queen.

He laughs and gallops away.

106 EXT. BEACHHEAD OSTIA PORT OF ROME - EVENING 106

Emperor Nero, (20's) watches the sea, his hair blowing in the sea breeze. He looks down at the tide splashing the hull.

NERO
I have only to appear and sing to have peace once more in Gaul.

Draws a DAGGER, places the pommel against the mast, grips the mast. Wrenches himself against the blade: BLOOD STREAMS as he crumples to the deck.

A high ranking CENTURION walks to where Nero has bled out.

It's Paulinus.

TACITUS behind him.

TACITUS
After many expensive conflicts; an insurrection in Judaea, and faced with multiple antagonists and conspiracies. The rebellion against Nero finally ends and a new era begins.
(beat)
It was only in death that the Queen of the Icini was able to strike her fatal blow to the boy Emperor.

Looking up, Paulinus sees a faint glimpse of the furies amongst the clouds

Finis.